

CM slams dilapidated state of govt office, calls disorder unacceptable

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Expressing displeasure over the dilapidated condition of a Government office in the Capital, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday told officials that such disorder was unacceptable in a place where a large number of people visit every day for important documentation and property-related work.

The Chief Minister made these observations after a surprise inspection of the Revenue Department's E-Sub-Registrar Offices VI-A (Model Town/Pitampura) and VI-C (Rohini), operating from Ambedkar Bhawan in Rohini Sector-16.

She also noted that the Government offices are meant to serve the public, not to trouble them. "Our Government's priority is to ensure that every citizen receives transparent, corruption-free and dignified services. No citizen should have to run from office to office or face harassment for getting legitimate work done," she said.

Rekha Gupta directed the concerned officials to submit a detailed report on the



improvement works carried out within one week. She said that she would personally conduct a follow-up inspection to review the arrangements and ensure the effective implementation of the directions issued to provide better facilities to citizens.

During the visit, she reviewed the condition of the office building, citizen facilities, cleanliness, record management and the services being provided to the public. The Chief Minister expressed displeasure over the dilapidated condition of the building, poor lighting arrangements, non-functional air-conditioners, broken flooring, unclean toilets, inadequate seating and negligence in maintenance.

The Chief Minister also

interacted directly with citizens present at the office and listened to their grievances. Several citizens complained about having to wait for long periods while standing, inadequate seating arrangements, the absence of a token system, poor air-conditioning and the lack of other basic facilities.

Directing the concerned officials on the spot, she said that citizens should not face any inconvenience and that it is the Government's responsibility to provide a dignified and comfortable environment in public offices.

Rekha Gupta said that the condition of the office building had remained neglected for years. Expressing surprise, she said that if lights were not working, toilets were unus-

able, floors were damaged and even basic seating arrangements for citizens were unavailable, it raised serious questions about administrative accountability.

She directed the concerned officials to submit complete records of all correspondence and repair proposals related to the matter. During the inspection, the Chief Minister also expressed concern over scrap material, unused items and the disorganised management of records in the building.

She directed that clear responsibility be fixed for the regular upkeep and maintenance of the premises and that a responsible officer or caretaker be designated in every office to ensure regular monitoring of basic facilities, cleanliness and maintenance.

The Chief Minister directed officials to complete the necessary facelift and improvement works within one week. This includes replacing all faulty lights, repairing air-conditioners, fixing broken floors and tiles, ensuring cleanliness, providing adequate benches and seating arrangements for citizens and developing better facilities for people waiting at the office.

Residents cite delayed response in the death of ex-CCI chief Dhanendra Kumar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

As flames engulfed former CCI chairman Dhanendra Kumar's Hauz Khas residence late at night, neighbours scrambled to remove cars from narrow lanes, form bucket chains and rescue trapped family members, with residents alleging that delayed fire tenders, chaotic parking and "fortress-like" barricading of colonies hampered the emergency response to the blaze that claimed the retired bureaucrat's life.

Days before his 80th birthday on June 6 and with preparations underway for a family gathering on May 30, Kumar, a retired IAS officer and former Executive Director representing India at the World Bank, died due to smoke inhalation after the fire broke out at his south Delhi home on Wednesday night. His son, who had flown in from London for Kumar's upcoming birthday celebrations, remains hospitalised after inhaling smoke while trying to rescue his father.

Residents of Hauz Khas Enclave said the tragedy exposed deeper concerns over emergency prepared-



ness in Delhi's gated colonies, where roads are often blocked or narrowed due to security barricades and indiscriminate parking.

"This could have been avoided if the fire department had not taken so much time to respond. I made the first call around 11.15 pm and then three more calls, but it took them around 50 minutes to come. By that time we were trying to douse the fire ourselves along with police personnel using water buckets," Abhishek Ranjan, Kumar's manager for the past 14 years, said

According to Ranjan, the fire started after a suspected short circuit in the indoor unit of an air-conditioner and quickly spread through curtains and furniture on

the ground floor. "The entire ground floor is gutted," he said.

The first alarm, residents said, came not from sirens but from a night guard patrolling the colony.

"The guard on night duty saw the blaze and alerted neighbours, who joined the staff members to help douse the fire," Kumar's next-door neighbour, who did not wish to be identified, said.

As panic spread, residents rushed downstairs to move vehicles blocking access to the house.

"Apart from fire tenders being late, the cars parked on both sides of the roads also delayed movement.

Some neighbours immediately tried to remove their vehicles. Parking on both sides is a major problem and

something should be done," the neighbour said.

Several residents also pointed to another issue increasingly common in Delhi neighbourhoods - colonies turning into "fortresses" at night with barricades and restricted entry points.

"There is also a problem that in areas like Hauz Khas Enclave, colonies are barricaded from all sides in the name of security. It creates problems during emergencies," the neighbour said.

Another resident, Juvesh Gupta, said Delhi's emergency response system was struggling to cope with the city's maze of sealed colonies and gated neighbourhoods.

"At night, colonies get sealed off in the name of security. But if roads are blocked from all sides, how will ambulances or fire brigades enter? In emergencies, they waste 15-20 minutes just figuring out the route or waiting for the gates to open," he said.

Though Gupta clarified that Hauz Khas Enclave remained accessible from multiple sides, he said the issue reflected a larger city-wide problem.

Filling district-level gaps priority, Delhi BJP team in 2 months: Harsh Malhotra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A day after taking charge as president of the Delhi unit of the BJP, Harsh Malhotra on Friday said that gaps in the organisation at the district level will be filled as a priority. Malhotra, who is also the MoS Road Transport and Corporate Affairs in Narendra Modi Government, said that

the new team of Delhi BJP will be formed in the next couple of months. "The teams in the districts will be formed in next 15-20 days, while the reorganisation of the state unit and appointment of office bearers will be completed in next two months," said Malhotra.

The first assignment fallen on the shoulders of Malhotra, will be fortnight long programmes in June marking 12

years of Modi Government at the Centre and BJP Government in Delhi. Immediately after taking charge on Thursday, he also held a meeting with party MPs, MLAs, councilors and district presidents to discuss preparations for the programmes.

Regarding preparations of MCD elections scheduled in November-December next



year, the Delhi BJP President said that the party is always active on ground keeping interests of the people in centre and will surely achieve the desired results. He said that Centre, Delhi Government and BJP-ruled MCD is performing well in the national Capital and the reason people have been supporting them.

Malhotra said he was comfortable discharging the

duties of state president as well. He is Lok Sabha MP from East Delhi. Those who have more workload, are given more work because they have capacity for it, he said and added time management was part of his schedule while working as Lok Sabha MP as well as a minister. "Party organisation is not just the president. Its teamwork and there are teams for every-

thing. I am confident that I can balance both responsibilities," he said about his role as a minister and Delhi BJP chief.

The newly elected Delhi BJP Chief also said that the party will work to support the efforts of its Government in Delhi led by Chief Minister to serve the people. He stressed that the coordination between the Government and the state unit has been good since day one.

UNITED LEASING AND INDUSTRIES LIMITED						
Regd. Office : Plot No 66 Sector 34 EHTP Gurgaon, Haryana-122001						
CIN NO.: L17100HR1983PLC033460, Phone : 011-2628237, Email : teamunited83@gmail.com						
EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEARENDED ON 31ST MARCH, 2026						
(Rupees in Lakhs)						
Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended			Year ended	
		31/03/2026	31/12/2025	31/03/2025	31/03/2026	31/03/2025
		Audited	Un Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited
1	Income from Operations	137.05	262.83	229.02	714.14	785.28
2	Net Profit for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3.47	11.93	(12.75)	17.29	16.74
3	Net Profit before tax for the period (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3.47	11.93	(12.75)	7.21	16.74
4	Net Profit for the period after tax and Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items	(0.80)	11.93	(18.23)	2.95	11.26
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising profit for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after Tax)	(0.80)	11.93	(18.23)	2.95	11.26
6	Equity Shares Capital (Face value Rs.10/- Per equity share)	300.00	300.00	300.00	300.00	300.00
7	Earnings Per Share (for continuing and discontinued Operations) Basic and diluted	(0.03)	(0.40)	(0.61)	0.10	0.38
Notes:						
1. This extract of the detailed format of Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under the Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results are available on the stock exchanges website : www.bseindia.com The same is also available on the company's Website www.ulitltd.com						
2. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the company at their Meeting held on 27th May, 2026.						
3. The Company has no subsidiary/associate/Joint Venture Company(ies).						
4. The Operations of the company are considered as a single business product. Segment reporting is not applicable.						
For UNITED LEASING AND INDUSTRIES LIMITED						
Sd/-						
ASHISH KHANNA						
MANAGING DIRECTOR						
DIN: 01251582						
Place : New Delhi						
Date : 28-05-2026						

सार्वजनिक सूचना	
गणजियाबाद नगर निगम, वसुन्धरा जोन	
सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है, कि भवन सं०-205-Vasundhara Sec-10C पिन सं०-VS37373 गणजियाबाद नगर निगम के वसुन्धरा जोन सम्पत्ति कर अभिलेखों में वर्तमान में दर्ज नाम Jaipal Singh के स्थान पर Neelima Singh के द्वारा अपना नाम दर्ज किये जाने हेतु पति की मूल्य उपरांत मूल्य प्रमाण-पत्र, बरिसान प्रमाण पत्र के साथ रायच-पत्र, फंडाचन पत्र, व निश्चित नामपरिवर्तन शुल्क जमा कर ऑन-लाइन आवेदन किया गया है।	
आवेदक/आवेदक गण के प्राथम-पत्र व संलग्न साक्ष्यों के आधार पर सं०-205-Vasundhara Sec-10C पिन सं०-VS37373 पर नाम परिवर्तन किये जाने से पूर्व निगमानुसार नगर निगम अधिनियम 1959 की धारा 213 का नोटिस सर्व्वधित पक्षों को दिनांक 25.02.2026 को जारी की जा चुकी है।	
यदि उपर्युक्त भवन के नाम परिवर्तन किये जाने पर किसी भी व्यक्ति को कोई आपत्ति है, तो वह समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशन की तिथि से 30 दिवस के भीतर अपनी लिखित आपत्ति मय साक्ष्यों सहित जौनल कार्यालय वसुन्धरा जोन, गणजियाबाद नगर निगम में प्राप्त करा सकते हैं। नियत समयवधि 30 दिवस के अन्दर कोई आपत्ति प्राप्त न होने की स्थिति में आवेदक/आवेदक गण Neelima Singh का नाम सं०-205-Vasundhara Sec-10C पिन सं०-VS37373 पर दर्ज कर दिया जायेगा।	
AXIS BANK Axis Bank Ltd., Retail Asset Centre, 2nd Floor, Property #7-E, Municipal 3903/1142/16, Malhar Road, Sarabha Nagar, Luthiana -141001 Registered Office: "Trishul" 3rd Floor Opp. Samartheshwar Temple, Near Law Garden, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad -380006	
Appendix IV (Refer Rule – 8(1)) Possession Notice (For Immovable Property) Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Bank Ltd. under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued pursuant to the said Act, do hereby give notice to the Borrower(s) (Co-Borrower(s)) Mortgage (s) Guarantor(s) and the Public in General that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 dated 26-05-2026. The Borrower(s) (Co-Borrower(s)) Mortgage(s) Guarantor(s) above said in particular and the Public in General is hereby cautioned not to deal with the properties and any dealings with the properties will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount of Rs. 12,82,105/- (Rupees Twelve Lakh Eighty Two Thousand One Hundred Five Only) as on 18-Sep-2025 and interest and cost thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The Borrower(s) (Co-Borrower(s)) Mortgage(s) Guarantor(s) above said having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) (Co-Borrower(s)) Mortgage (s) Guarantor(s) and the Public in General that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 dated 26-05-2026. The Borrower(s) (Co-Borrower(s)) Mortgage(s) Guarantor(s) above said in particular and the Public in General is hereby cautioned not to deal with the properties and any dealings with the properties will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount of Rs. 12,82,105/- (Rupees Twelve Lakh Eighty Two Thousand One Hundred Five Only) as on 18-Sep-2025 together with further interest thereon at the contractual rate of interest till the date of payment & expenses thereon. The Borrower(s) (Co-Borrower(s)) Mortgage(s) Guarantor(s) attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. Description of immovable property All that part and parcel of Property bearing: Flat No.32, LIG 2 Floor, Block B 21, Sec.35, Pkt.5, Rohini, DDA Rohini, New Delhi-110085 East : As Per Title Deed, West : As Per Title Deed, North : As Per Title Deed, South : As Per Title Deed Please note that as mentioned in sub Section 13 of Section 13 of the aforesaid Act, you shall not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise any of the assets stated under security referred to in this notice without prior written consent of our bank. Date: 26-05-2026, Place: Rohini New Delhi-110085 Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.	
PUBLIC NOTICE Notice is hereby given to the General Public on behalf of our client Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services Ltd. that Mr. Birendra Kumar Kushwaha is the owner of Middle Portion of Plot No. 61, land area 400 Sq. Yards, SAID PORTION, Kharsa No. 99, Village Noor Nagar, Tehsil and District Ghaziabad, UP, vide Regd. Sale Deed dated 26.12.2024, Doc No.15551. All persons are hereby informed that above mentioned Owner wants to mortgage the said portion to our client & intends to obtain a loan against the said portion, if anybody has any objections upon the ownership of above owner over the said portion, its Sale mortgage/litigation & any other objections, kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 7 days of the present. Kumar & Associates (Advocates & Consultants) 200, 1st Flr, 23, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, N Delhi-15 Ph: 011-41112527-28 legal@knaagati.com	
PUBLIC NOTICE Notice is hereby given that my client, Mr. Aniket is in process to purchasing the Second Floor Without Roof Rights in respect of Property bearing No. 10/101, Plot No. 19, Area Measuring 277 Sq. Yards, situated in village, WEA, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005 (hereinafter referred to as the "said Property") from Bankney Bihari Commodities Pvt. Ltd. by availing the loan from TCMFL. That Bankney Bihari Commodities Pvt. Ltd., had purchased the entire Property from Mr. Jai Kishan Sethi, Mrs. Kavita Sethi and Mr. Manav Sethi vide Sale Deed dated 28/11/2023 Doc. no.808, whereas one Ms. Preet Sethi, who was minor at that time, also had a share/interest in the said Property, which was dealt with by her natural guardian/mother Mrs. Kavita Sethi, and now Ms. Preet Sethi has attained majority and confirmed that she was fully aware of the said transaction. She has declared that she has no right, title, claim, interest, objection or dispute of any nature whatsoever in respect of the said Property and shall not raise any dispute in present or future vide through Ratification cum undertaking dated 28/5/2026 All persons having any claim against or in respect of the said Property, or any part thereof, by way of sale, exchange, mortgage (equitable/registered or otherwise), gift, trust, inheritance, family arrangement, maintenance, bequest, partnership, possession, lease, sublease, tenancy, license, lien, charge, pledge, easement or otherwise however, are hereby requested to notify the same in writing to us with supporting documentary evidence at the address mentioned below within 07 days from the date hereof, failing which the claim or claims, if any, of such person or persons will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned. Kamal Kant Gupta (Advocate) Unit No. FF-2, First Floor, Mahalaxmi Metro Tower Sec-4, Vaisali, Gzb., U.P., Mob. 9810063551	

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM	
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PWD (ROADS), CACHAR CIRCLE, SILCHAR	
No:-T/CC/ETN/SIL/2026-27/231(T)	
PRESS NOTICE INVITING RE-TENDER (e-Procurement)	
The Superintending Engineer, PWD (Roads) Cachar Circle, Silchar on behalf of Governor of Assam, re-invites bids against this office earlier press notice No. T/CC/ETN/SIL/2025-26/1359(T), Dtd. Silchar, the 09th March/2026 for 3(Three) No. of packages for Construction of Roads under Mukhya Mantrir Nagariya Pakipath Nirman Achani (MMNPPNA) under SOPD-G for the year 2025-26, within Cachar District of Assam (under Silchar LAC) amounting to approximately Rs. Rs. 373.10720 Lakhs (Rupees Three Crore Seventy Three Lakh Ten Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty) only including GST etc. within the jurisdiction of P.W.R.D. Silchar and Udharbond Territorial Road Division, Silchar from approved and eligible contractors registered with Public Works Department (Roads), Assam.	
Details may be seen at website www.assamtenders.gov.in and also in the office of the undersigned during office hours from 02/06/2026, 10:00 hours onwards. Amendment /Addendum to the SBD, if any, and further notifications shall appear in this website and also at the office of the undersigned during office hours. The contractor/bidder must be registered with the Electronic Tendering System (ETS) of PWRD, Assam website www.assamtenders.gov.in .	
Note:- N.I.T. Value is inclusive of GST (12%), Labour cess(1%) etc.	
Sd/-	
Superintending Engineer, PWD, (Roads)	
DIPR/C/PIO/69/30-May-26	
Cachar Circle, Silchar.	



MODI RUBBER LIMITED

CIN: L25199UP1971PLC003392, Registered Office: Modinagar - 201204 Dist. Ghaziabad (U.P.), Corporate Office: 4-7C, DDA Shopping Centre, New Friends Colony, New Delhi 110025

Website: www.modirubberlimited.com Email: investors@modigroup.net Phone: +91-11-2684 8416

EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED UN-AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026											
(Amount in Lacs)											
Sl. No.	Particulars	QUARTER ENDED						YEAR ENDED			
		STANDALONE			CONSOLIDATED			STANDALONE		CONSOLIDATED	
		31-Mar-26	31-Dec-25	31-Mar-25	31-Mar-26	31-Dec-25	31-Mar-25	31-Mar-26	31-Mar-25	31-Mar-26	31-Mar-25
		Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Audited	Un-Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited
1	Total Income from operations (Net)	128.04	142.65	123.31	1,202.60	731.52	703.87	468.98	399.61	3,424.67	2,920.10
2	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	(898.38)	(186.51)	(675.23)	(1,140.86)	512.93	135.88	(1,945.90)	304.92	276.21	2,192.96
3	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	(898.38)	(186.51)	(675.23)	(1,140.86)	512.93	140.54	(1,945.90)	304.92	276.21	2,192.96
4	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period after tax (after exceptional items)	(918.94)	(204.68)	(492.83)	(1,387.87)	507.87	116.11	(1,941.32)	235.96	63.97	2,046.06
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (after tax)	(1,335.87)	(145.25)	(2,102.99)	(2,386.17)	828.18	(2,049.41)	(2,614.50)	885.38	(1,167.01)	2,747.88
6	Equity Share Capital (Face value of share is Rs. 10/- each)	2,504.05	2,504.05	2,504.05	2,499.55	2,499.55	2,499.55	2,504.05	2,504.05	2,499.55	2,499.55
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves as per Financial Statements of previous year)	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A	N.A
8	Earnings per share (EPS) (of Rs. 10/- each) (Not Annualised)										
	(a) Basic and Diluted EPS (before exceptional Items) (in Rs.)	(3.67)	(0.82)	(1.97)	(5.55)	2.03	0.46	(7.75)	0.94	0.26	8.19
	(b) Basic and Diluted EPS (after exceptional Items) (in Rs.)	(3.67)	(0.82)	(1.97)	(5.55)	2.03	0.46	(7.75)	0.94	0.26	8.19

- NOTES:**
- The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/ Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/ Annual Financial Results are available on the stock exchange website, www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on the Company website www.modirubberlimited.com.
 - The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their respective meeting held on May 29, 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out an audit of the aforesaid results.
 - Previous quarter/ year end figures have been rearranged and / or regrouped, wherever necessary, to make them comparable with those of the current quarter/ year end.

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that M/s S.G. Estates Private Limited has been accorded environment clearance from State Environment Impact Assessment Authority, (SEIAA), Uttar Pradesh vide EC Identification No. EC25C3801UP5173799N Proposal no. SIA/UP/INFRA2/550646/2025 and File No. 10850 for Proposed Group Housing Project "SG Orchard" At Kharsa No- 351 & 350 (New Kharsa No. 350M), Vill. Bhovapur, Pargana, Jalalabad, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. Copy of said Environment Clearance letter is available on the website of Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change at <https://parivesh.nic.in/>

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that my client, Anita Kalsi, is the absolute owner of Entire Ground Floor of the property with 22.5 % undivided share of the Entire Stilt of Property no. P-83 area measuring 252 sq. yds. Situated in the residential colony known as New Delhi South Extension Part-II (NDSE Part-II) New Delhi having acquired the said property by virtue of a Gift Deed dated 3/2/2026, Doc No.2026/7/11589, duly executed by Anil Dip Singh Kalsi. That my client is availing a credit facility from HDFC Bank Ltd. against the said property in the name

Absorbing Varghese as professor violates all UGC rules: DU tells St Stephen’s college

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi University has formally directed St Stephen’s College not to proceed with a proposal to absorb outgoing Principal John Varghese as a professor in the college’s English Department. The university stated in a letter dated May 29 that such an absorption would violate all UGC regulations and university rules, that any recommendation by the Governing Body to this effect is ultra vires, and that Varghese must instead be repatriated to his parent institution upon completion of his tenure.

The letter, written by DU Registrar Vikas Gupta to the Chairman of the Governing Body of St. Stephen’s College,

was issued with the approval of the Competent Authority. Copies were marked to the Chairperson and Secretary of the UGC for information and necessary action.

The communication states the university’s position with precision. The UGC, which funds colleges, sanctions substantive teaching posts only at the Lecturer or Assistant Professor level. Teachers appointed as Assistant Professors are subsequently promoted to Associate Professor and Professor through the Career Advancement Scheme under UGC Regulations 2018.

The letter then draws the logical conclusion: neither the UGC Regulations nor any rules approved by the statutory bodies of the university

provide for the direct absorption of an employee or any person as a Professor in a college. “In view of the above, it is apparent that the absorption of Prof. John Varghese as Professor in the college is in violation of all rules of UGC and the University,” the Registrar wrote. He then added: “Accordingly, any such recommendation of the Governing Body is ultra vires and should not be acted upon any further. You are requested not to proceed with this.”

The letter also addressed the question of Varghese’s future entitlements. Under existing rules, the university said Varghese should be repatriated to his parent institution after the completion of his tenure and would



draw pension and other retirement benefits from that institution. It explicitly stated that no retirement benefits or pension in his regard could be booked under UGC funds provided to St

Stephen’s College.

The university also referenced the ongoing legal challenge to Varghese’s continuation as principal, noting that the grant of a second term to him was itself “in violation of

UGC Regulations 2018” and that the matter remains pending before the Delhi High Court.

The timing of the letter is significant. It arrives days after DU asked the college to

halt the appointment of Professor Susan Elias as its new 14th principal, on the grounds that the selection committee constituted for her appointment was not formed in compliance with UGC Regulations 2018. Elias is expected to take charge on June 1, regardless, with the college relying on its minority institution status and a 2008 Delhi High Court ruling that had held St. Stephen’s was not bound by Delhi University Ordinance provisions regarding selection committees for principals.

Meanwhile, Varghese’s name has already appeared on the college’s English Department page on its website, while the Principal’s page has been left empty. Notably, Varghese’s faculty

profile in the English Department continues to list him as principal of the college.

The latest development deepens a long-running institutional conflict between Delhi University and St. Stephen’s over governance, appointments, and the extent of autonomy enjoyed by the college as a minority institution. DU has previously described Varghese’s extended tenure as principal as illegal, non-statutory, and null and void from inception, arguing that UGC rules required a fresh selection process involving the university and UGC nominees. The college maintained his continuation was valid under resolutions passed by the college’s supreme council.

SC gives two-month deadline to fill Delhi power regulator posts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday asked a selection committee appointed by the city government to ensure the appointments of the chairperson and two members to the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission within two months.

A bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant passed the order after the Rekha Gupta-led Delhi Government said that it constituted a search and selection committee on May 27 to fill up three vacant posts in DERC in terms of an earlier direction. The bench — which also included Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice Vipul M Pancholi — asked the search panel to ensure that the appointments of the DERC chairperson and two members were completed in two months and sought a compliance affidavit.

It also asked the government to file a compliance affidavit after two months when the matter will be taken up again. Lawyer Pranav Sachdeva, appearing for the petitioner



‘Energy Watchdog’, an NGO, had urged the bench to direct the panel to ensure the appointments within one month.

The DERC is a statutory body for regulating the power sector in the national capital. It sets the price of electricity, grants licences to utility companies, ensures quality of service, and resolves disputes between consumers and power providers.

Earlier, the bench had directed the Delhi government to inform it when the selection committee will be notified for making regular appointments of chairperson and members in the

DERC. The bench was informed that a proposal regarding the constitution of the selection committee was moved on May 4.

Sachdeva had alleged that the DERC was not taking up adjudicatory functions for the last one year.

The top court had earlier sought a response from the Delhi government on a plea seeking a direction to make regular appointments of chairperson and members in the DERC.

The NGO, in its plea, had referred to an August 2025 order of the apex court in which it was recorded that the counsel appearing for

the Delhi government had assured that the process of regular appointments in the DERC would be completed expeditiously.

The plea said that despite the assurance given before the apex court, the explicit statutory provisions of the Electricity Act, 2003, and an April 2018 verdict mandating the inclusion of a judicial member/person of law as a member of the commission, the Delhi government failed to take any steps to make regular appointments in the DERC.

It claimed that the present composition of the DERC was wholly contrary to the law as it consisted of only two pro tem members, and lacked a chairperson as well as a person of law as member.

“Since the pro tem members are operating solely pursuant to a temporary mechanism devised by this court in the interest of justice, the petitioner is constrained to approach this court to seek vacation of their appointments and to seek directions for the regular appointment process to be

undertaken in accordance with law,” the plea said.

It argued that the lack of a judicial member/person of law completely disabled the DERC from fulfilling its adjudicatory functions.

“This violates the consumers’ right under Articles 14 and 21, inasmuch as petitions/applications under Section 142 of the Electricity Act are no longer being heard or listed as per administrative notice/noting on the cause list dated July 15, 2025, of DERC’s website... which came to be issued after the chairperson Justice (ret’d) Umesh Kumar superannuated in July 2025,” the plea said.

It claimed that the status quo also violated the core premise of the Electricity Act, which requires the state electricity regulatory commissions to be autonomous and independent from governmental interference.

The plea said regular, tenured appointments ensure impartiality and autonomy in discharge of both the adjudicatory and regulatory functions of the DERC.

DU to open registrations for 1-year PG courses soon: Officials

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi University will begin registrations for its newly introduced one-year postgraduate programmes in the next few days, officials said on Friday, even as the admission process for the existing two-year postgraduate courses is currently underway. While admission to the two-year PG programme is based on the Common University Entrance Test (CUET-PG), admission to the one-year programme is for DU students only, officials said.

“This is the first time that the one-year PG programmes are being introduced, in line with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 framework. The one-year programme will be available only for DU students with a four-year Bachelor’s honours degree with research or entrepreneurship, or those with a four-year Bachelor’s degree with a major in the concerned subject,” said Haneet Gandhi, dean of admission, DU.

Gandhi said four-year UG students can apply for both the one-year and two-year PG programmes, provided they fulfill the eligibility criteria.



“The registration for the one-year programme is going to begin very soon. A separate portal will be launched for this,” Gandhi said.

Meanwhile, registration for the two-year PG programme began on May 16 and will be open till 11.59 pm on June 7. In a webinar held on Friday to explain the nuances of the application process for the two-year programme, Gandhi reiterated that from this year, the university will auto-integrate candidates’ credentials through the DigiLocker or API Setu platform.

DU has also added a one-time provision for changing the social category following the auto-integration. Speaking on the application process, officials said students will be able to apply only in the subjects they appeared for in the

CUET-PG exam.

“Students should fill up the maximum number of possible subject preferences,” said DU deputy dean of admission, Anand Sonkar.

Once the form is submitted and the fees are paid, the university will proceed with the first round of allocation; the schedule is expected to be declared shortly.

“On declaration of the allocations, students have to log into their CSAS (Common Seat Allocation System)-PG portal and accept the allocated seat,” said Sonkar, adding that students must accept the seat first to use the “upgrade” or “freeze” options. In the subsequent rounds, once a student avails the option to upgrade, they will be considered for their higher preferences, Sonkar said.

JNU extends hostel stay for final-year Master’s students till June 30 for UGC-NET

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) has extended hostel stay until June 30 for final-year Master’s students following representations from students seeking accommodation support ahead of the UGC (University Grants Commission)-NET (National Eligibility Test) examination.

In a circular issued on Friday, the Office of the Dean of Students said the extension would be provided as a “special dispensation” on a case-to-case basis, subject to conditions laid down by the university administration.

“As per Rule 2.9.1 of the IHA Hostel Manual, all terminal (final-year) students must surrender their rooms by May 31 each year,” said the circular, adding that the Dean of Students may grant extensions in exceptional cases in consultation with the provost committee.

It said, “The Senior Wardens of the respective hostels are hereby authorised to examine and process the requests received from the terminal Master’s students for limited extension.”

The circular said terminal

Master’s students seeking the extension would have to stay as guests and submit applications along with a mandatory undertaking to their respective hostel wardens.

The university also directed students to clear all outstanding hostel dues before applying for the extension, warning that applications with pending dues would be rejected.

Students granted the extension will have to pay advance mess charges, calculated on the basis of the previous month’s bill along with an additional 10 per cent amount, according to the circular.

“No mess rebate will be permitted for terminal Master’s students during the extended period,” the circular said.

The administration clari-



fied that no extension beyond June 30, 2026, would be granted under any circumstances and said the present arrangement should not be treated as a precedent for future academic sessions.

Meanwhile, the Jawaharlal Nehru University Students’ Union (JNUSU) welcomed the decision and said no student should be forced to vacate hostel rooms before the NET examinations.

The students’ union also appealed to terminal Master’s students facing difficulties in availing the extension to contact JNUSU office bearers for assistance.

The issue of hostel accommodation for terminal students had triggered concerns among students appearing for competitive examinations, including the UGC-NET, scheduled in June.

Juvenile with ‘crime’ tattooed on hand, held for setting motorcycle ablaze

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A juvenile who had the word “crime” tattooed on his hand, ran a social media account under the username “king_of_azadpur_001”, and had five prior criminal cases against him, including an attempt to murder charge, was apprehended by Delhi Police. The accused was arrested for allegedly setting a man’s motorcycle on fire after the owner refused to lend it to him and his associates for a liquor run.

The incident took place in Delhi’s Adarsh Nagar area when the accused and two other minors approached a man named Subedar and



asked to borrow his motorcycle to buy liquor. When Subedar refused, the three juveniles allegedly set the vehicle on fire in retaliation. “The incident took place after the accused and his associates asked the complainant, named Subedar, for his

motorcycle to buy liquor. When Subedar refused, the three minors allegedly took revenge by setting the vehicle ablaze,” a senior police officer said.

The accused had been evading arrest by frequently changing locations to avoid

being traced. He came onto the police radar during surveillance of criminals and anti-social elements operating in the district.

What made the case stand out was the trail the juvenile had left on social media. Police noticed an account allegedly operated by him under the name “CRIME” and the username “king_of_azadpur_001”.

The account featured photographs, videos, and status updates showing firearms and glorifying criminal activities. The content was creating fear among local residents and young people in the area. “During monitoring of social media activities, police noticed a social media account allegedly operated by

the juvenile. During interrogation, police found that he was allegedly using social media platforms to flaunt weapons, promote a criminal lifestyle, and create an image of dominance in the locality through posts and videos,” the officer said.

The tattoo on his hand, reading “crime,” and the social media persona together present the picture of a teenager who had consciously constructed a criminal identity and sought to project it publicly. His followers in the locality and online had apparently taken the persona seriously enough for police to note that the content was generating fear among residents.

Investigation revealed that this was not the juvenile’s first encounter with the law. He had previously been found involved in five criminal cases covering a range of offences: snatching, assault, theft, mischief by fire, and attempt to murder. The combination of a violent offline history and an active online presence used to amplify that image made him a subject of targeted surveillance before the motorcycle arson case brought him to arrest.

Police are now probing the involvement of the two associates who were allegedly present during the incident and examining the juvenile’s possible links to other criminal activities in the area.



allegations from the Enforcement Directorate, according to which the corporation collaborated with retailers to increase its market share illegally in 2021.

Justice Purushendra Kumar Kaurav rejected a Pernod Ricard India Pvt Ltd’s petition assailing a February order of the financial commissioner, which upheld the excise commissioner’s May 2025 decision rejecting its L-1 licence applications due to a pending money laundering prosecution by the Enforcement Directorate.

In its petition, Pernod Ricard, “which is facing prosecution in the money laun-

dering case related to the 2021 excise policy ‘scam’, contended that unless there is a conviction, it cannot be treated as having a “criminal background” for denying an L1 licence under the Delhi Excise Act.

The plea further stated that since the trial court in February discharged all accused persons in the scheduled offence being probed by the CBI, prosecution under the related money laundering case has also become untenable. It said the petitioner was not a “fly-by-night operator” and has an unblemished 30-year record.



Govt announces free DTC travel for NEET candidates

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government has announced free travel in all DTC buses for students appearing in the NEET (UG) 2026 examination scheduled for June 21. Candidates will be allowed to use the facility by showing their valid NEET admit cards while travelling on Delhi Transport Corporation buses across the city.

The move is aimed at helping students reach examination centres without transportation problems and reducing stress on one of the most important examination days for medical aspirants. Officials said the arrangement has been made to ensure smooth travel for candidates appearing in the highly competitive national-level entrance examination.

The Delhi Government also said DTC buses would provide improved connectivity on routes linked to Metro stations and major examination centres. The transport arrangements are expected to help students travelling from different parts of the capital with easier last-mile access on the day of the examination.

Transport Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh welcomed the decision and thanked Chief Minister Rekha Gupta for approving what he described as a student-focused initiative. He said the government wanted students to focus

entirely on the examination instead of worrying about travel arrangements.

“The Delhi Government is committed to ensuring that NEET aspirants can appear for their examination without transportation concerns,” Dr. Singh said. He added that free DTC travel and better connectivity arrangements would help students reach their centres smoothly and on time.

Officials said the initiative reflects the government’s broader effort to create a supportive environment for students during major examinations. Thousands of students from Delhi and nearby areas are expected to appear for NEET (UG) 2026, which serves as the gateway for admission to undergraduate medical courses across the country.

The government said reducing travel-related inconvenience was important because many students experience stress and anxiety before competitive examinations. By offering free travel and strengthening public transport connectivity, authorities hope to ease some of that pressure for candidates and their families.

According to officials, the transport department and DTC have already begun preparations to ensure smooth operations on examination day. Special attention will be given to routes connecting residential areas with examination centres and Metro stations to avoid delays and overcrowding.

IN FOCUS



A peacock displays its plumage, in Gurugram, Haryana

PTI

Alleged carjacker shot at after attempting to overpower PCR officer

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

Police said a 26-year-old man accused of carjacking was shot in the leg by a PCR officer late Wednesday in Najafgarh after he allegedly tried to snatch the officer's pistol while fleeing.

Police said that on May 27, they received a PCR call about two men allegedly robbing and assaulting a person before fleeing with his car in Najafgarh. Upon arrival, police found the caller missing. Shortly after, a second PCR call reported that one of the suspected carjackers had been shot in the leg.

The police identified the injured man as Aakash, 26, of Gopal Nagar, who was hospitalised. Complainant Arun Kumar Arya, 26, of Najafgarh, and PCR in-charge ASI Narender Singh were also at the hospital. The complainant alleged that Aakash and an accomplice robbed him of his Hyundai Aura, after which he notified the police.

The complainant accompanied the PCR team to search for the stolen vehicle. After spotting the car, the team chased it. The suspects abandoned the vehicle in a narrow lane and tried to escape on foot.

Anti-terror operations intensify across Rajouri, Poonch districts

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

A relentless chase to hunt down a group of Pakistani terrorists, spotted in the forest belt of Dorimal-Gambhir Moghla of Rajouri district, continued for the seventh consecutive day on Friday.

At the same time, another anti-terrorist search operation was also launched in neighbouring Poonch district after the suspected movement of three terrorists came on the radar of the security forces in the area.

The ongoing search operations in the Rajouri district were expanded to nearby forest areas to hunt down the foreign terrorists after a fresh round of massive fire assault was launched on their suspected hideouts inside the thickly vegetated forested



Security personnel maintain a tight vigil amid an ongoing encounter between security forces and terrorists following an anti-terror operation in the dense forest area of Dori Maal, in Rajouri district, Jammu and Kashmir

area on Thursday. A fresh round of firing was also reported in the area early Friday morning, even as additional reinforcements were rushed in to launch the massive crackdown.

Security forces have been diligently tracking the movement of the suspects, follow-

ing blood stains believed to have been left by the fleeing terrorists on Monday.

Operation Sherwalli began last Saturday after an encounter broke out between terrorists and security forces in the Dorimal-Gambhir Moghla belt following intelligence inputs about the pres-

ence of terrorists in the area. Meanwhile, Army Commander Northern Command, Lt-Gen Pratik Sharma, visited units deployed along the Line of Control in Kupwara Sector on Friday to assess the robustness of the anti-infiltration grid and review operational preparedness.

The Northern Command posted on X, "The Army Commander Lt-Gen Pratik Sharma witnessed a demonstration of innovations successfully implemented in field conditions to integrate Unmanned Aerial System (UAS) and Counter Unmanned Aerial System (CUAS) with Techniques Training and Procedures (TTPs) for enhanced combat capabilities along the Line of Control".

6 dead as under-construction bridge collapses in UP

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Hamirpur

Six labourers were killed and three others injured, after part of a bridge under construction collapsed following a storm over the Betwa river in Uttar Pradesh's Hamirpur district early Friday, officials said.

One Assistant Engineer has been suspended in this connection on charges of negligence (in discharge of duty), an official of the Uttar Pradesh State Bridge Corporation Ltd said. The incident occurred around 3 am between Parsani and Kandaurl villages under the Lalpura police station area, around 25 km from the district headquarters.

Several labourers engaged in the bridge construction work were sleeping on the upper portion of a slab when it suddenly gave way, they said. Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath expressed grief over the incident and directed officials



Locals gathering at the site after part of an under-construction bridge collapsed following a storm over the Betwa river in Hamirpur

PTI

to ensure proper treatment of the injured.

Hamirpur District Magistrate Abhishek Goyal and Superintendent of Police Mrigank Shekhar Pathak reached the spot and inspected the rescue operation being carried out by SDRF teams.

Goyal told reporters that the

work was being carried out by a private company and the project had been underway for the last two years. He said all safety arrangements for labourers had been made at the site. Goyal said the India Meteorological Department (IMD) and the district administration had issued warnings on

Thursday evening regarding strong winds, storms and rainfall.

Announcements were made in villages to alert residents and workers about the adverse weather conditions, he said. The deceased were identified as Lokendra (22), Kuldeep Nishad (19), Sawant Yadav (28) and Sabhajeeet (30), Pushpendra Chauhan (34), and Rajesh Pal (42), police said.

Three labourers were trapped under a pillar and later rescued. The injured were admitted to the district hospital in Hamirpur. "Construction work was being carried out at night due to the excessive heat during the day, even though an alert for severe storms had already been issued. Assistant Engineer Gajendra Chaudhary has been suspended on charges of negligence," Dilip Kumar, Deputy Project Manager of Uttar Pradesh State Bridge Corporation Ltd, Hamirpur, said.

PM supervising NEET: Govt to SC

"It is not the individual who has the capability, it is the institution which has the capability. That is what you need to prepare," the bench said.

The bench asked the Union Government to file an affidavit indicating how and in which manner the process of conduct and conclusion of the examination, year after year, will be done.

"The endeavour is to ensure that NTA would have the wherewithal, physical as well as intellectual, to ensure that no incidents such as the 2024 or 2026 examinations occur," the bench said.

It said the affidavit will be filed by the Union Government within six weeks and posted the matter for hearing in the second week of July.

On May 12, the NTA cancelled the NEET-UG, held on May 3, amid allegations of paper leak. A re-examination has been scheduled for June 21. The paper leak allegations are under investigation by the CBI.

Earlier the SC had observed that it is sad that the NTA has not learnt lessons from the earlier NEET paper leak.

MPs briefed on NEET-UG leak

The panel called officials from the ministry, NTA, NMC, and CBI to answer questions about the Government's promises to Parliament regarding how the testing agency conducts exams.

They informed the Parliament's Committee on Government assurance about the steps being taken to ensure the June 21 NEET-UG retest is transparent and to prevent cheating.

The panel instructed officials to keep the seat matrix for medical admissions up to date and ensure student counselling is conducted on time. The seat matrix lists how medical and super-specialty seats are divided by quota and category. The CBI chief provided updates on arrests and ongoing efforts to apprehend the remaining suspects in the paper leak case.

Ministry officials outlined measures to ensure the NEET-UG on June 21 is fair. The committee called officials after the Government gave an assurance to the Rajya Sabha on November 27, 2024, about the "Conduct of Examination by NTA" in response to an unstarred question.

In its November 2024 reply, the Education Ministry stated that, according to the NTA, exam contracts are issued in accordance with current Government rules and guidelines.

IMD warns of weakest monsoon in three years

During June 2026, below normal monthly rainfall is very likely over most parts of the country, except over some parts of Northwest India, Northeast India and south Peninsula and isolated pockets of central India where normal to above normal rainfall is likely.

According to IMD, the estimate carries a model error margin of plus or minus 4 per cent and points to a higher likelihood of deficient rainfall across the country during the season. The revision marks a significant worsening of the outlook.

While the Northeast is likely to witness normal rainfall this monsoon season, the

remaining parts of the country may see below normal rainfall, he said.

Mohapatra said El Nino is confirmed to hit India during the monsoon season, bringing the rainfall levels to the lowest the country has seen in the last 3 years. El Nino conditions are likely to be weak in June, and moderate to strong in September. Mohapatra also laid out how the incoming El Nino will strengthen in the coming months. The concerns are being amplified by a growing consensus among international weather agencies.

Currently, neutral El Nino-Southern Oscillation conditions are transitioning towards El Nino conditions over the equatorial Pacific region. For India, the developments are particularly significant because El Nino has historically been associated with weaker monsoon rainfall, more frequent heatwaves and increased stress on agriculture and water resources.

The long-period average (LPA) of seasonal rainfall over the country as a whole, based on data from 1971 to 2020, is 87 cm. LPA refers to the rainfall recorded over a particular region for a given interval, such as a month or season, averaged over a long period of time, typically 30 to 50 years.

The average rainfall for the country as a whole in June is most likely to be below normal — less than 92 pc of the LPA, he said. If the monsoon season sees less than 90 pc of LPA rainfall, the IMD classifies it as 'deficient'.

Speaking about the monsoon's onset over Kerala, Mohapatra said it is expected to happen in the next seven days.

Typically, Kerala witnesses the onset of southwest monsoon around June 1, which marks the beginning of the southwest monsoon season in the country. The weather department also highlighted that in June, above normal monthly maximum temperatures are likely over most parts of the country.

Amit Shah unveils quad grid for borders

Alongside this overhaul, infrastructure work accelerates in Gujarat's Sir Creek and Harami Nala sectors. Watchtowers, roads, water, medical facilities, and fencing are progressing rapidly, with Shah promising the region will be "leak-proof" in two years.

"Within two years, this region will be permanently secured," said Shah, adding that troop living conditions are also being improved with large investments and new technology. All outpost areas in Bhuj are now raised above previous levels.

The announcement coincides with rapid infrastructure improvements in Gujarat's sensitive sectors, including new watchtowers, roads, water supply systems, medical facilities, and fencing.

Shah emphasised investments and technology to improve troop welfare and upgrade the borders in the Bhuj sector.

Technological fencing in West Bengal's riverine stretches is advancing with greater state cooperation. Experts say the grid addresses hybrid threats, demonstrating that community and civil involvement are vital for defence. "Once this grid is in place, no one will breach our borders," he said. The BSF's duties will grow. Fencing along West Bengal's border is progressing faster due to Government action.

FROM PAGE - 1

Security experts say the initiative will be closely watched as India moves to modernise its border architecture in an era of advanced surveillance, drone warfare and cross-border hybrid challenges. Implementation is expected to begin immediately in priority sectors along both western and eastern frontiers.

NIA probes Pakistan-linked drone-based...

The NIA took over the case in early April at the direction of the Union Home Ministry. They registered the case under several acts. Investigators are still trying to confirm Chaudhary's real identity and find other group members. Friday's raids mark a major step. The raids aimed to collect evidence, seize illegal items, and identify the wider support network. Officials emphasise the need to focus on dismantling local logistics for cross-border operations. Drone smuggling poses a serious new threat.

Security agencies have detected numerous drones crossing the Punjab-Jammu border. These drones carry weapons, drugs, and cash for terror activities. Intelligence points to Chaudhary directing drone drops to sleeper cells and exploiting border weaknesses. The NIA recently filed similar charge sheets. Experts note such operations disrupt smaller, harder-to-detect terror plots.

Sources from the Home Ministry said Friday's searches yielded some early leads, but details remain secret. "The agency is working in close coordination with state police forces. Further arrests and seizures are expected as analysis of digital devices and documents proceeds," one official said. In the areas searched, NIA teams kept a low profile and focused on places linked to suspects. No one was detained right away. Officials said several people are being questioned.

Analysts note that this case shows cross-border handlers are using new tactics, including technology, drones, encrypted apps, and social media. These help them evade traditional security checks. The case also reveals weaknesses in smaller towns and cities. Local helpers, often young people or petty criminals, play a key role. With tensions high along the borders, the NIA's quick action is a clear message of zero tolerance. "We will not allow any foreign element to disturb peace and security," a senior security official said. Authorities have urged the public to report suspicious drone activity or possible smuggling. The agency is also investigating possible links to foreign funding. The case is ongoing, and multiple agencies are involved. More raids and arrests are expected soon, helping uncover the network behind the plot.

Twisha death probe deepens with digital...

The agency is reportedly employing a "tunnel view investigation" approach to reconstruct Twisha Sharma's final hours. Using CCTV footage, mobile phone data, Wi-Fi logs, call detail records, and forensic mapping of the three-storey residence, investigators are creating a virtual timeline of her movements and interactions before her death.

Sources said the CBI is also developing a digital avatar of Twisha to simulate her last known movements within the house. The reconstruc-

tion is expected to help identify inconsistencies in witness statements, suspicious activity, and possible gaps in the sequence of events.

Investigators are simultaneously examining call records, tower location data, and digital evidence to determine who was contacted on the night of the incident and whether the crime scene was altered after her death.

Twisha's family immersed her ashes in the Ganga at Triveni Ghat in Rishikesh on Friday, performing the last rites according to traditional rituals.

The CBI formally registered an FIR in the case on May 25 and arrested Giribala Singh on May 28 after more than seven hours of questioning at her residence. During the investigation, officials reportedly found indications suggesting possible tampering with evidence.

The probe has also uncovered financial and domestic abuse allegations. Investigators learned that Twisha had investments worth around Rs 20 lakh in shares of several companies. According to her family's legal counsel, Samarth Singh and Giribala Singh allegedly pressured her to transfer those shares in their names.

The investigation further revealed that Twisha had informed her mother about alleged dowry-related harassment and physical abuse. She reportedly claimed that both accused subjected her to mental harassment, including pressure related to having a child.

MHA clears record CAPF deployment for 57-day...

The policemen also remain vigilant during the yatra period to gather human intelligence to ensure an incident-free pilgrimage.

The jawans of the Railway Protection Force (RPF) and the Government Railway Police, Jammu and Kashmir, are also geared up to provide foolproof security cover to the pilgrims travelling on board Vande Bharat to perform the annual pilgrimage. Adequate security measures have been taken in advance to ensure the safety of the track and the railway property.

Recently, Director General of J&K Police, Nalin Prabhat, while chairing a security review meeting, was informed that the paramilitary companies will start reaching the UT by early June and the entire deployment will be in place on or before June 25 i.e. around a week ahead of the start of the annual pilgrimage. The officers also briefed the DGP regarding the administrative and logistical arrangements made for the incoming Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF) companies.

US-Iran Ceasefire Faces Political Roadblocks

"We do not gain concessions through talks, but through missiles. In negotiations, we only make them understand that," wrote Qalibaf, who was involved in negotiations in Qatar this week. He added: "The winner of any agreement is the one who is better prepared for war the day after it is signed."

According to a US official familiar with the matter, the tentative agreement would continue the ceasefire in the 3-month-old war by 60 days and start a new round of talks on Iran's nuclear programme.

Spurious liquor kills 14 men in Pune, 8 held

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ Pune

At least 14 men died after consuming suspected spurious liquor in Pimpri Chinchwad area and Pune city, with the police arresting eight persons, including a key bootlegger, in this connection, officials said on Friday.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis termed the incident as very serious, and said further action was being taken as the "entire ecosystem" involved in the supply of spurious liquor has been identified.

The probe into the entire tragedy was transferred to the Crime Investigation Department (CID), a senior official said. Ten persons died in the Phugewadi area of Pimpri Chinchwad, while four others from the



Pandhare Mala area in Pune's Hadapsar succumbed after consuming suspected spurious liquor.

Five men suspected of consuming toxic liquor are undergoing treatment at a hospital in Pimpri Chinchwad, police said.

During the probe, police arrested Karnelsingh, Gurmangat, Karnelsingh, Yogesh, Radhesham Hariram Prajapati, Indarjit Kaur Karnelsingh Virka and Kalpesh Agrawal in connection with the case.

Defence minister, CM Yogi to inaugurate Nausena Shaurya Vatika in Lucknow

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ Lucknow

Defence minister Rajnath Singh and UP chief minister Yogi Adityanath will inaugurate the 'Nausena Shaurya Vatika'—dedicated to the bravery, valour, and excellence of the Indian Navy—in Lucknow on Saturday.

Uttar Pradesh Tourism and Culture Minister Jaiveer Singh said the 'Nausena Shaurya Vatika' is a tribute to the brave warriors of the Indian Navy.

He said the museum developed in CG City is a special gift from the Yogi Adityanath Government to the people of the State. It will inspire future generations.

Commemorative book on Op Sindoor released

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Friday here released a commemorative volume on Operation Sindoor, documenting the personal testimonies of 100 officers, sailors, airmen and other soldiers who participated in the operation.

In a post on social media, Rajnath Singh termed the publication as a tribute to those who executed this operation, providing a connection with the devotion and resilience of soldiers. "The citizens need to draw inspiration from this book and be citizens worthy of the tremendous cost the nation pays to ensure security and maintain sovereignty," he said.

The defence minister described Operation Sindoor as an unprecedented success wherein India compelled Pakistan to seek a ceasefire within four days. It was different from all other wars



that India has fought so far, he wrote, adding that this commemorative publication goes beyond historical account and captures the personal experiences of brave soldiers.

It also offers insight into the human dimension of modern warfare where leadership, courage, judgement

under pressure and commitment translate strategy into success, he stated.

The volume departs deliberately from the conventions of official military historiography. Most accounts of war privilege the view from the headquarters and the operations room, as the decisions of commanders

are recorded, analysed and debated.

Yet the texture of the war as it was actually lived — by the soldier on the Line of Control targeting adversary bunkers, the air defence operator tracking and neutralising inbound drones, the pilot in the cockpit at the moment of weapons release

and the sailor at action stations as the fleet moves to a heightened posture — is almost always lost.

This book is an attempt to recover that texture. The accounts span across the three services as well as headquarters and integrated defence staff and include combat aviators, naval

watchkeepers, surface-to-air missile crews, special forces operators, signallers, logisticians, medical officers and the personnel of the joint and integrated organisations that knit the operation together.

The publication was released during a ceremonial function attended by Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) General Anil Chauhan, Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, Chief of the Army Staff General Upendra Dwivedi, and Chief of the Air Staff Air Chief Marshal A P Singh.

The volume has been compiled under the guidance of the CDS. Personal accounts from the services are contributed by the Additional Directorate General of Strategic Communication, Media and Public Information Cell and the Directorate of Media and Public Relations, while publication support has been provided by the United Service Institution of India.

PM only cares about survival of his Govt, not kids' future: Rahul



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi said on Friday that Prime Minister Narendra Modi's silence on the CBSE debacle and inaction against the education minister showed he cared only about the survival of his government and not the future of lakhs of students.

In a post on X, Gandhi said he had been demanding an independent judicial probe from day one into the CBSE's on-screen marking and the award of the contract to COEMPT as the youth of the country deserved to know the truth. Gandhi shared media reports and called upon people to read them carefully.

"CBSE called for OSM tenders thrice. Zero bids the first time. No qualified bidder the second time. And finally, the technical bar was lowered until COEMPT could clear it. Scanning resolution cut. Robotic scanner requirement dropped. CMMI certification lowered from Level 5 to Level 3. Penalties for errors in answer sheets removed.

"TCS, India's biggest IT services company, qualified in the third round too. TCS lost. COEMPT - a company with a spectacular track record of failure - won. And what are CBSE students complaining about today? Badly scanned answer sheets. Missing pages. A broken evaluation portal," he said.

Gandhi said teachers had warned the CBSE that the OSM system needed at least a year or two for further preparation before nationwide implementation, yet it was rushed through.

"So I ask again - who wanted COEMPT to win? Who lowered the bar, step by step, until this company could clear it? "Pradhan ji and CBSE say "due process was followed." That is not an answer, that is not accountability. The question is whether the contract was honestly awarded to the best company which could do the job correctly," the leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

He said the futures of 18.5 lakh children were handed to a company that could only qualify after the rules were "bent" for it.

"To the BJP ministers attacking me for asking questions - I have, from day one, demanded an independent judicial probe. Expand it from CBSE to every contract awarded to COEMPT. Our youth deserve the truth.

"And Modi ji, your silence on the CBSE debacle and inaction against the Education Minister tells the country what you actually care about - not the futures of lakhs of students, only the survival of your own government," Gandhi said.

The Congress leader also shared a video of his earlier interaction with students who had taken the NEET exam and expressed their concerns over the exam system in the wake of the paper leak.

India, Singapore review bilateral defence ties

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India and Singapore reviewed the entire gamut of their bilateral defence ties and reaffirmed their commitment to an open and rule-based Indo-Pacific during the 16th India-Singapore Defence Policy Dialogue in Singapore on Thursday, the defence ministry said here on Friday.

Giving details, officials said Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh and Permanent Secretary (Defence) Joseph Leong co-chaired the Dialogue.

Both Secretaries reviewed the progress of ongoing defence engagements and held wide-ranging discussions on key areas of defence cooperation, military



tary engagements, defence industry collaboration, capacity building and regional security issues.

They also explored new avenues for further strengthening the strategic relationship and expanding cooperation in areas of mutual interest, including collaboration

between the industries.

The two countries also discussed enhancing cooperation in niche and emerging domains such as cyber security, artificial intelligence, maritime security, unmanned systems, and advanced defence technologies. The discussions underscored the importance of

innovation-driven partnerships and deeper collaboration in emerging areas to address evolving regional and global security challenges.

The two sides appreciated the continued cooperation between India and Singapore in regional and multilateral forums, including Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)-led mechanisms and the ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting-Plus (ADMM-Plus) framework.

Both countries reiterated their commitment to supporting an open, inclusive, and rule-based regional security architecture while promoting practical and constructive defence cooperation in the Indo-Pacific region.

Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar takes over as Vice Chief of Navy

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar, who drove high-level naval combat readiness during Operation Sindoor, assumed charge as the 48th Vice Chief of the Indian Navy on Friday, bringing a wealth of frontline experience to the naval headquarters.

Before taking the helm as the Navy's second-in-command, the officer served as the Commander-in-Chief of the Andaman and Nicobar Command (ANC), India's first and only integrated tri-services theatre command guarding strategic waters.

Earlier, as the Chief of Staff

of the Western Naval Command, he was instrumental in executing the Navy's aggressive forward deployment of critical assets as part of Operation Sindoor.

Vice Admiral Kochhar succeeds Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan, who has been appointed as the next chief of the Western Naval Command.

An alumnus of the prestigious National Defence Academy, Pune, Vice Admiral Kochhar was commissioned into the Indian Navy on July 1, 1988.

A specialist in gunnery and missile systems, he has held a wide range of command, operational, and staff assignments over his



Newly-appointed Vice Chief of the Naval Staff (VCNS) Vice Admiral Ajay Kochhar, left, with outgoing VCNS Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan during the Guard of Honour, at South Block Lawn in New Delhi

distinguished career spanning more than 37 years.

He has commanded warships Nashak, Vibhuti, and

Kirpan and was the commissioning commanding officer of the frigate Trikanth. The Flag Officer has also commanded

Govt notifies two Special Economic Zones in Puducherry

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

The Government has notified two special economic zones (SEZs) to be developed in Puducherry, including the one for the IT sector, an official statement said on Friday.

The proposals were already approved by the Board of Approval for SEZs under the Department of Commerce during its 137th meeting held on February 27. Out of these two SEZs,



one IT/ITES SEZ will be developed by Oulgaret Municipality at Thattanchavady village in Oulgaret Taluk.

"This will be the first SEZ in India to be developed by an urban local body," the commerce ministry said.

The other, a multi-sector SEZ, will be developed by the Pondicherry Industrial Promotion Development and Investment Corporation (PIPDIC) at Karasur village in Villianur Taluk.

Chandrashekhar remembered as ideological warrior at PMML discussion

KHUSHI MEHROTRA
■ New Delhi

A panel discussion on the legacy and leadership of former Prime Minister Chandrashekhar, held at the Prime Ministers Museum and Library (PMML) on Friday, revisited the political turbulence between the 1970s and late 1990s. Speakers described him as a bold, ideological leader who never had political stability or his due place in history.

The discussion, moderated by Dr Ravi Mishra, Joint Director of PMML, featured Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Harivansh and veteran journalist and political commentator Neerja

Chowdhary. Chowdhary described Chandrashekhar as "a prime minister that India would have liked to see with a majority," recalling that he often expressed frustration over the limitations of heading a minority government. "He used to say, 'How much can I do with such an unstable arrangement?'" she said.

Calling him "dhakad", a Hindi term she said went beyond merely being "bold", Chowdhary recounted several anecdotes from his tenure as prime minister.

Both speakers dwelt on Chandrashekhar's ideological convictions and his strained ties with former prime minister VP Singh. Harivansh said



From left to right: Dr Ravi Mishra, Joint Director of PMML, Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman Harivansh and veteran journalist Neerja Chowdhary

the two leaders were "poles apart," with Chandrashekhar emerging from a poor socialist background and building his politics around opposition and ideological struggles.

He said Chandrashekhar

never accepted VP Singh's leadership and believed he had been sidelined within the Janata Dal despite being a taller political figure.

A major focus of the discussion was Chandrashekhar's

attempts to resolve the Ayodhya dispute through dialogue. Chowdhary said he initiated talks involving the Vishva Hindu Parishad, the Babri Masjid Action Committee and other stakeholders soon after taking office and that the discussions had come close to a resolution.

According to her, leaders feared that if he succeeded, Chandrashekhar would emerge as a "national hero." The discussion pondered Rajiv Gandhi's withdrawal of support to his government.

Harivansh also highlighted Chandrashekhar's conduct during the Emergency, alleging that he refused inducements offered in exchange

for withdrawing support from Jayaprakash Narayan and opposition leaders.

"He chose imprisonment over compromise," Harivansh said, describing him as one of the last leaders to consistently raise ideological questions in Indian politics.

The speakers also touched upon Chandrashekhar's handling of the economic crisis during his short tenure, including the controversial mortgaging of gold reserves.

Harivansh said Chandrashekhar did not want to be remembered as the leader who "mortgaged gold to save the nation", adding that the gold involved was confiscated gold that never left the country.

States Focus



NO OTP WILL BE ASKED IN CENSUS 2027 IN HIMACHAL: OFFICIALS

No One Time (OTP) password will be asked for in the upcoming Census 2027, which will be conducted in two phases in Himachal Pradesh, officials said on Friday. The first phase, scheduled from June 16 to July 15, will involve house listing and the housing census, during which detailed information about every housing unit and household in the state will be collected. A total of 33 questions have been outlined for this phase. Addressing the media here, Director Census Operations cum Citizen Registration, Himachal Pradesh, Deep Shikha Sharma said that a new facility of self-enumeration has also been introduced, which could be availed through the self-enumeration portal se.census.gov.in from June 1 to 15.



GOVT COMMITTED TO TAKING YOGA TO EVERY HOUSEHOLD: CM SAINI

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday chaired a high-level meeting to review preparations for the International Yoga Day and directed officers to ensure grand scale and extensive public participation. The theme for this year's International Yoga Day is 'Yoga for Healthy Ageing'. The chief minister said the state-level main event will be organised in Panchkula, while special yoga programmes will also be conducted at the district, sub-division and gram panchayat levels to ensure yoga reaches every section of society.

the aircraft carrier INS Vikramaditya.

During his tenure, the aircraft carrier successfully completed the integration and operationalisation of its air wing. A graduate of the Defence Services Staff College, Wellington, the Naval War College, Goa, and the Royal College of Defence Studies, UK Vice Admiral excelled in key strategic and policy-oriented staff roles at the Naval headquarters, according to the Indian Navy.

On promotion to flag rank in 2018, he served as the assistant controller of carrier projects and the assistant controller of warship production and acquisition.

He subsequently commanded the Western Fleet in 2021 and thereafter served as Commandant, National Defence Academy, where he focused on enhancing training standards and infrastructure. The Flag Officer assumed charge as Chief of Staff, Western Naval Command, on May 25, 2024, amidst a challenging security situation in the Western maritime theatre.

He spearheaded the command's response to conventional and non-traditional threats along the Western Seaboard, including high-tempo naval operations during Operation Sindoor, the Navy said.

BJP alleges Kerala Govt insulted Vande Mataram

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Friday criticised the Congress-led Kerala government for allegedly insulting Vande Mataram and the governor by playing only the opening stanzas of the national song during a function at the state assembly.

The remarks came after Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar expressed displeasure over Vande Mataram not being sung in full in the assembly when he was present for the United Democratic Front (UDF) government's policy address.

Before and after the governor's policy address in the Kerala Assembly, a band team performed the opening stanzas of Vande Mataram.

In a video message posted on social media, BJP national spokesperson Shehzad Poonawalla alleged that the Congress-led government violated constitutional protocol by not ensuring that the full version of Vande Mataram was sung.

"During the governor's address in the Kerala Assembly, the full version of Vande Mataram was not sung. The official protocol is that the original version



should be sung in full and not shortened to two stanzas. But the Congress government violated this protocol," he said.

Poonawalla alleged that it was done under pressure from the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML), an ally of the ruling UDF in Kerala.

"To appease the Muslim League, the Congress has done this because it is in alliance with the party and cannot go against it. The Muslim League hates Vande Mataram. Under its pressure, they have cut short Vande Mataram and insulted the governor," he claimed.

He also accused the Left of supporting the move.

"Only two stanzas were played, and former chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan also justified it. Both the Congress and the Left have no respect for the country and the Constitution," Poonawalla further alleged.

■ States Focus ■



NABIN PAYS TRIBUTE TO EX-CM BC KHANDURI IN DEHRADUN

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Friday paid tributes to senior party leader and former Uttarakhand chief minister Bhuvan Chandra Khanduri, who passed away on May 19, at his residence in Dehradun. On the second day of his three-day tour of Uttarakhand, Nabin went to the departed leader's residence in Basant Vihar here to meet the family members and offer condolences. He was accompanied by BJP national general secretary (organisation) BL Santhosh, Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhama, and state party president Mahendra Bhatt. Khanduri, popularly known as 'General Sahab', died on May 19 at the age of 91 following a prolonged illness. (PTI)



WET SPELL FORECAST IN HIMACHAL TILL JUNE 4

The weather office here on Friday forecast a wet spell in Himachal Pradesh till June 4, issuing an alert for thunderstorm, lightning and gusts at 40-50 kmph across the district. The inclement weather warning was issued for 10 districts, barring Kinnaur and Lahaul and Spiti, for Saturday (May 30). Light to moderate rain and snow is likely at few places on May 30, while light rain and snow is likely at isolated places between May 31 and June 4, the Met said. Light rains were witnessed in isolated places in Sirmaur and Lahaul and Spiti districts in the 24 hours since Thursday evening. Nahan in Sirmaur received 14.2 mm of rain, followed by Poanta Sahib at 6.4 mm, Dhaulakuan at 3.5 mm, Kalpa at 2.5 mm, Kukumseri at 2.1 mm, Keylong at 2 mm, while Renuka and Jatun Barrage saw 1 mm rainfall each. (PTI)

Previous Govt delayed census for political reasons: Suvendu

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Friday alleged the previous Trinamool Congress government failed to act on a communication from the Centre about the Census exercise, causing the state to lag behind others in preparations for the nationwide enumeration process.

Addressing a press conference after chairing a meeting on the first phase of the census at the state secretariat, he claimed the Centre had written to the then state government in February last year to initiate preparatory work for the census, but no action was taken.

"The previous government did not start the census process for political reasons. The then chief secretary was also waiting for a political concurrence."



"Because the previous government did not undertake any census-related work, other states have moved much further ahead while we have fallen behind," Adikari said.

Describing the situation as "unfortunate", the chief minister said his government moved quickly to bridge the gap. "After taking charge, I took several decisions at the first cabinet meeting on May 11 in the presence of the

chief secretary. One of them was to begin the census process," he said.

The chief minister announced that census operations in West Bengal would commence on August 1 and continue till the end of February next year.

Adhikari said Census Director Rashmi Komal would oversee the entire exercise in the state. He said data collection will be carried out between August

1 and August 15 during the initial phase.

The Bengal CM also unveiled two toll-free helpline numbers for people to lodge complaints or seek assistance related to the exercise.

He said the upcoming census would be conducted digitally for the first time.

Government employees engaged in the enumeration process will collect data using a dedicated mobile app and upload the information directly to a central server. Sources said that the development of the application was nearing completion.

Stressing the importance of the exercise, Adhikari said, "The census has no connection with politics. It is a constitutional obligation." He appealed to people to cooperate with officials to ensure the smooth conduct of the enumeration process.

Andhra Pradesh to finalise population management policy in 3-4 months

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Amaravati

The population management policy being promoted by Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu is expected to be finalised within three to four months after consultations with stakeholders across sectors, official sources said.

Alarmed over a declining fertility rate, which has fallen below the replacement level of 2.1, the Andhra Government is poised to introduce the population management policy soon. "We are not bringing a law. It is a discussion framework that will evolve into a policy in three to four months after consultations," Principal Secretary, Health, Medical and Family Welfare Department, Saurabh Gaur said.

The proposed policy, under discussion as a framework, aims to manage demographic changes and build population resilience while sustaining long-



term economic growth in the state.

The policy may include financial incentives of ₹30,000 for the third child and ₹40,000 for the fourth child, as recently announced by Naidu.

The state has a demographic window only until 2040 to make corrections before the dependency ratio

skews heavily towards the elderly population, he said.

Considering this reality, Gaur said the third guiding principle among the 10 Swarna (golden) Andhra@2047 vision principles focuses on a transformative approach to population management and human resource development.

Technology must serve humanity: VP Radhakrishnan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Davanagere (Karnataka)

Vice President C P Radhakrishnan on Friday said engineers, scientists, researchers, and entrepreneurs would play a crucial role in India's aspiration to become a developed nation by 2047.

He stressed the need for ethical development and said technology should ultimately benefit humanity.

Speaking at the inaugural ceremony of the 75th platinum jubilee celebrations of University BDT College of Engineering here, he said that India is witnessing a new era of transformation driven by technology, innovation, and the strength of its talented youth.

The vice president said the country, under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has strongly focused on initiatives such as Digital India, Make in India, Startup

India, and Skill India.

"We are also advancing in semiconductor manufacturing and green energy, and this Atmanirbhar Bharat is going to set the tone for the world in the future," he said.

Clarifying that India's leadership would be constructive and inclusive, he said, "We want India's development to benefit humanity most positively."

Emphasising that these national missions are creating vast opportunities for young engineers, researchers, innovators, and entrepreneurs, he said the 21st century will belong to nations that invest in knowledge, innovation, research, and human capital.

According to him, engineering institutions have a crucial responsibility to nurture problem-solvers, innovators, ethical leaders, and nation-builders in line with the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.



"I am happy to note that this college has taken important initiatives to strengthen research and innovation through ICT-enabled labs, drone technology laboratories, advanced research infrastructure, and innovation ecosystems. Such initiatives are essential to prepare our youth for a rapidly evolving global technological landscape," he said.

Radhakrishnan said the country is witnessing an

extraordinary transformation in artificial intelligence, semiconductor technology, green energy, digital infrastructure, aerospace, biotechnology, and advanced manufacturing.

"India's aspiration to become a developed nation by 2047 will depend greatly on the contributions of engineers, scientists, researchers, and entrepreneurs from institutions like this. You have an important role to play in the

development of Karnataka and the nation, and in realising this vision," he told students.

Calling teachers the "true architects" of society, Radhakrishnan said their influence extends far beyond classrooms and laboratories.

"Your education bestows upon you a responsibility towards society and the nation. Use your knowledge with humility, integrity, and compassion. Let innovation be guided by ethics," he said.

The vice president said development must always be guided by strong ethical values and that technology should ultimately serve humanity.

Appealing to the youth to stay away from drugs, he said, "You must say no to drugs and encourage your friends, families, and society to do the same. Let your thoughts be guided by your own values, not by external influences."

Gujarat: Eight lion cubs die of suspected Babesia infection, says Arjun Modhwadia

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Gandhinagar

Eight lion cubs have died due to a suspected 'Babesia' infection in Gujarat's Gir Somnath and Amreli districts, state Forest Minister Arjun Modhwadia said on Friday.

To prevent potential spread, authorities have isolated lions living within a 10-km radius of the areas where the infection has been reported, he said.

"In the suspected Babesia-related cases, eight cub deaths have come to light," the minister said.

Babesia, a parasitic disease, spreads through ticks and can cause weakness, coughing and nasal discharge in affected animals.

The deaths of the big cat cubs due to suspected Babesia infection have been reported in the revenue



areas outside the Gir sanctuary, particularly in Gir Gadhada of Gir Somnath and Babra Kot of Amreli districts, he said.

A team of veterinary doctors collected samples, which have been sent to the state-run Gujarat Biotechnology Research Centre for testing.

The report is expected within the next three to four

days, which will confirm if the deaths are due to Babesia infection, he said.

No such "incidents (deaths)" have been reported in the last two days, he said.

"Forest officials, along with a team of veterinary doctors from Junagadh, visited the site and isolated the lions living within a 10-km radius," Modhwadia said.

DG CISF chairs operational review meeting at Chandigarh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

Director General, Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) Praveer Ranjan on Friday chaired an Operational Review Meeting at Chandigarh on Friday to assess operational preparedness and security arrangements across the North Sector and Airport Sector of CISF.

Addressing the commanders, DG CISF Praveer

Ranjan commended the professionalism and unwavering commitment of the force's personnel. He emphasised that the combination of continuous physical training, inter-agency coordination, and rapid technology adoption is vital to address modern threat vectors. He also lauded the soft skills training programmes conducted in partnership with airline operators to improve passenger interface and service standards.

Senior officers and unit commanders of various units participated in the meeting, where detailed discussions were held on strengthening security preparedness, enhancing response capabilities through better inter-agency co-ordination, and adoption of advanced technologies for protection of critical infrastructure and civil aviation installations.

The review assumes significance in view of evolving



security challenges in border and strategically sensitive regions, particularly in Jammu & Kashmir, Punjab, Rajasthan, Haryana, and Gujarat.

During the meeting, emphasis was laid on strengthening preparedness against emerging threats, including drone-related challenges, anti-sabotage measures, and disaster response capabilities.

To counter low-altitude aerial threats effectively, the CISF has rolled out a phased Counter-Drone Training Programme for its personnel in close collaboration with the Indian Army. Conducted at multiple specialised locations, this programme equips personnel with advanced capabilities to detect, track, and neutralise hostile Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAVs).

The meeting also reviewed joint training initiatives being undertaken with the Indian Army and other agencies in the areas of counter-terrorism, quick reaction response, and disaster management.

These include CI/CT Training, QRT Specialised Training, Battle Inoculation Training with the Army, and the Art of Living resilience programme for improved mental resilience and stress management among personnel in operational zones.

CISF personnel have undergone specialised training programmes at various Army establishments and with the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) to strengthen tactical response and emergency handling capabilities.

In the aviation sector, the CISF reviewed the progression of key technological and operational upgrades across the commercial airports under its protection.

BIHAR BJP ANNOUNCES NEW OFFICE-BEARERS FOR PARTY'S STATE UNIT

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Patna

The Bihar BJP on Friday announced a new team of state office-bearers, along with heads of its various organisational fronts (morchas).



According to a statement, state BJP president Sanjay Saraogi announced the new team following instructions from the party's national chief Nitin Nabin.

The list includes 14 state vice-presidents, five state general secretaries, 14 Pradesh mantris, one state treasurer, two co-treasurers, one state headquarters in-charge and one office minister.

Assam, Meghalaya CMs discuss inter-state border dispute

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and his Meghalaya counterpart Conrad K Sangma on Friday decided to expedite resolving the inter-state border dispute. A delegation led by Sangma met his Assam counterpart in Guwahati and held discussions on several issues concerning the two States.

In a post on X, Sarma said, "It was an honour to welcome the enterprising chief minister of Meghalaya and my dear brother Conrad Sangma to Lok Sewa Bhawan today. We had an excellent discussion and have made some good progress on long-standing issues." On the boundary demarcation process, the two sides agreed to expedite the ongoing process and bring a lasting solution to the matter, he added. "In the spirit of Ek



CM Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma meets Meghalaya delegation led by CM Conrad Sangma and Deputy CM Sniawbha Dhar in Guwahati. PIONEER PHOTO

Bharat, Shreshth Bharat, Assam and Meghalaya are collaborating in various fields and exploring synergies that will boost the growth trajectory of the Ashtalakshmi region," Sarma said. Prime Minister Narendra Modi has termed the eight northeast-

ern states India's 'Ashtalakshmi'— representing the multifaceted nature of prosperity, wealth, and auspiciousness. The Chief Minister's Office said the discussions focused on key inter-state matters, including the Assam-Meghalaya boundary, with

both sides reaffirming their commitment to mutual respect, friendship and continued dialogue.

Assam and Meghalaya have a longstanding dispute in 12 areas along the 884.9-km-long inter-state border.

The two states had signed an agreement in March 2022 in the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi to end disputes in six areas. Under the first-phase settlement at six places covering 36.79 sq km of disputed land, Assam received 18.46 sq km, and Meghalaya got 18.33 sq km. The remaining six areas, where the differences are more complex, are now being addressed in the second phase. Meghalaya was carved out of Assam in 1972 and has since then challenged the Assam Reorganisation Act, 1971, which is recognised by Assam as its border.

Attack on ED officials serious offence: Kerala CM Satheesan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ Thiruvananthapuram

Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan on Friday said that the attack on ED officials after a search at Marxist veteran Pinarayi Vijayan's rented residence was a serious offence.

Breaking his silence on the issue, Satheesan told reporters here that what happened was a serious crime and that those involved could be classified as criminals, as they attacked an ED team that also included women officials.

"Attacking investigators and damaging their vehicles is a serious offence, and it should not be repeated. That is our position," he said, terming the violence as "cruel" and urging the CPI(M) not to encourage it. He praised state Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala for deploying police force to the places where searches were being carried out on seeing the increase in the crowd gathering at those places, even though neither the police nor the Home Department had received any information from the Enforcement Directorate (ED) about the search. The CM said that the state Government and police intervened when



there was a law-and-order issue, and "we have taken strong action in the matter" and there was no lapse on the part of the law and order agency.

Justifying the search by the ED, Satheesan said it was carried out in connection with a case already registered by a central agency and it was an ongoing investigation. He said that the Congress-led UDF too had raised allegations against Vijayan's daughter of having financial deals with a mining firm, CMRL, and that forms part of the ED probe.

He further said that the UDF had complaints about the central agency investigation itself as it was a four-year-old case, and nothing was done till the LDF Government stepped down from power.

SC directs HCs to pronounce judgement within 3 months of reserving order

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ New Delhi

Observing that delay causes irreparable loss to litigants, the Supreme Court on Friday directed high courts to pronounce judgements within three months from the date of reserving order, with faster decisions in cases of personal liberty.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi issued a slew of directions on a plea alleging delay in uploading of a high court judgement.

"In a matter where the judgement is reserved, the High Court shall endeavour to pronounce a reasoned judgement promptly, within a maximum period of 3 months from the date of reserving such judgement.

"The High Courts shall display extra promptitude in pronouncing judgements and orders in matters of personal liberty, e.g. regular bail, anticipatory bail, criminal appeals (where the convict is in custody), death references, etc.," the bench said. The apex court said orders in bail applications should be pronounced the same day, and if they are reserved, they must be pronounced and uploaded the next day.

"Orders granting regular bail, suspending sentence, or acquitting a convict in custody should be communicated to the jail authorities and the Trial Court on the date it is pronounced.

"Consequent upon the outcome, the undertrial/convict must be released on the same day



or, at most, on the next day, unless they are required to be taken in custody in another case, or there is a delay in complying with the bail conditions, etc.," the bench said.

The top court said in cases where, after hearing the parties, the HC is of the opinion that any delay in pronouncement of a reasoned judgement will cause irreparable loss to the

parties and urgent orders are required, the operative part may be pronounced in Court, and the reasoned judgement be uploaded within seven days or a maximum of 15 days.

"Such cases may include habeas corpus matters, criminal appeals resulting in the acquittal of a convict in custody, matters relating to demolition/eviction, matters relating to admission to educational institutions, or other urgent cases.

"A reasoned judgement pronounced in open court should be uploaded on the High Court website within 24 hours," it said.

The top court asked chief justices of high courts to make necessary changes to their websites, so that at the end of every month, automated emails are sent to

them, specifying all the reserved judgements pending in that month, along with a copy of the email to the bench that has reserved the judgement.

"The Chief Justice of the High Court may also circulate the statement of the cases, in which the judgements have not been pronounced within two months from the date of reserving such judgement, amongst the judges of the High Court for their information.

"The communication shall be conveyed as confidential and in a sealed cover. In the event the reserved judgement is not delivered within three months, the Registrar General shall place the matters before the Chief Justice for orders, and the Chief Justice shall bring it to

the notice of the concerned Bench for pronouncing the judgement within two weeks thereafter," the bench said.

The apex court exercising its extraordinary powers under Article 142 of the Constitution said if only the operative portion of the judgement is pronounced, the reasoned verdict must be uploaded within 15 days.

The top court directed that if the judgement is not pronounced within four months of reserving order, then parties can approach the Chief Justice of the high court to assign the matter to another bench.

The top court clarified that directions passed by it do not intend to cast aspersions on any particular judge or a high court judgement.

7 killed in lightning strikes across Bihar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ Patna

At least seven people died due to lightning strikes across Bihar on Friday, Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary said.

Choudhary has directed officials of the Disaster Management Department to provide ex gratia of ₹4 lakh each to the next of kin of the deceased.

Several Bihar districts were lashed by heavy rain accompanied by gusty winds and thunderstorms during the day. "Incidents of lightning strikes resulted in the untimely death of three persons in Gaya Ji district, two in Aurangabad, and one each in Saran and Khagaria.

My deepest condolences for the bereaved families. May God grant peace to the departed souls and provide strength to the families during this difficult time," Choudhary said in a post on X.

The CM urged people to exercise caution during inclement weather, and follow guidelines issued by the department for protection against lightning strikes.

Earlier in the day, Choudhary directed departments concerned to conduct a survey to assess crop damage caused by heavy rain and hailstorms in several districts.



Congress in hectic talks over Karnataka Government

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

Top Congress leaders were engaged in hectic deliberations on Friday over the new government formation in Karnataka on a day Governor Thaaawarchand Gehlot formally accepted the resignation of Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and dissolved the cabinet.

The Congress Legislature Party (CLP) in Karnataka will meet on Saturday at 4 pm in the conference hall in Vidhana Soudha, Bengaluru, to elect their new leader in the state. The meeting will be chaired by Siddaramaiah and D K Shivakumar is set to be elected as the new leader.

A day after resigning from the top post, Siddaramaiah, accompanied by his son Yathindra, met the Congress brass including Rahul Gandhi



Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge being greeted by Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister D K Shivakumar during a meeting, in New Delhi. PTI

and party president Mallikarjun Kharge in the national Capital.

The meeting with Rahul Gandhi at Sonia Gandhi's 10, Janpath residence at 9 am was significant as Siddaramaiah is learnt to have told the former party

chief that he has fulfilled his promise of resigning from the chief minister's post, paving the way for a smooth transition in Karnataka.

He is also learnt to have discussed his future plans and the new Government formation in the southern state

with Rahul Gandhi. Siddaramaiah has already declined a Rajya Sabha nomination, offered by the party leadership. He also said that he wants to remain in Karnataka and is not keen on a central role, which the party high command had suggested to him.

Sources said Siddaramaiah only met Rahul Gandhi, as Sonia Gandhi was not present during the meeting.

The outgoing chief minister is seeking berth for his son and loyalists in the new Karnataka Cabinet, including the post of deputy chief minister, the sources said.

Congress general secretary Randeep Surjewala, who was present during Siddaramaiah's hour-long meeting with Rahul Gandhi, said, "It was a very pleasant meeting. They discussed multiple political issues."

India sees drop in severe diarrhoea cases: NFHS-6

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

India has recorded a slight decline in severe diarrhoea cases among children under five years of age, with improved vaccination coverage and better access to safe drinking water contributing to gains in child health, according to the National Family Health Survey-6 (NFHS-6).

The prevalence of severe diarrhoea among children under five declined from 0.7 per cent in NFHS-5 to 0.5 per cent in NFHS-6, while coverage of all three doses of the Rotavirus vaccine among children aged 12-23 months increased sharply from 36.4 per cent to 85.4



per cent, the Health Ministry said on Friday.

It added that under-five mortality had also declined by 38 per cent from 45 per 1,000 live births in 2014 to 28 per 1,000 live births in 2024.

Rotavirus is one of the leading causes of severe diarrhoea and dehydration among infants and young children.

Ebola outbreak: India has sent first tranche of medical supplies to Africa CDC, says MEA

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

India has sent its first tranche of medical supplies to the Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC) amid the outbreak of Ebola in parts of the continent, the Ministry of External Affairs said on Friday.

On May 17, the World Health Organization (WHO) declared the Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda a Public Health Emergency of International Concern.

At his weekly media briefing, external affairs ministry's spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal was asked if India had sent any medical aid to Africa in the wake of the outbreak. "On your question, about the help that we have sent, we have sent medical supplies to CDC Africa. This was handed over by our High Commissioner in Uganda to CDC office there. We look forward to further helping, in whatever manner we can, with the countries and with the CDC," he said.

Africa CDC is a specialised technical institution of the African Union established in 2016 to support public health initiatives of member states and strengthen the capacity of their public health institutions to detect, prevent, control and respond quickly to disease threats. Africa CDC supports African Union member states in



providing coordinated and integrated solutions to the inadequacies in their public health infrastructure, human resource capacity, and disease surveillance. Jaiswal told reporters, "We will keep you updated as and when we have more developments on that account."

He was also asked if, following the postponement of the fourth India Africa Forum Summit, which was scheduled to be held late May in Delhi, any tentative timeline had been discussed to hold the summit at a later date. According to international media reports, the Congolese Government has confirmed over 1,000 suspected cases, with at least 220 deaths, since it declared an outbreak on May 15.



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NIT No. 709/MPRDC/Procu/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS
Madhya Pradesh Road Development Corporation Limited (MPRDC) Bhopal invites online tenders for the following work :-

S. No.	Name of Work	EPC (in INR Crore)	Bid Security (EMD) (in INR Lacs)	Cost of Tender Document (i/c GST) (in Rs.)	Period of Completion
1.	Construction of Viaduct with pile foundation, RCC pier, RCC/PSC girder and reconstruction of RE Wall with the replacement of backfill & ground improvements in the remaining approaches of ROB at Km 28+200 in the Jabalpur to Hiran river section of NH-45 on EPC mode	65.31	32.66	59,000/-	6 Months
2.	Empanelment of Agency for Road Data Collection survey using Network Survey Vehicle, Pavement Strength using Falling Weight Deflectometer and Providing Input Data for Road Asset Management in MPRDC	-	0.50	5,000/-	3 Years

The dates for purchase, submission, etc. are mentioned in the key dates. Tender forms can be purchased online only upto **15:30 hrs. on 09.07.2026** from website **www.mptenders.gov.in**. The bidders have to submit the **Technical bid as well as Financial Bid online only**. The Addendum/Corrigendum (if any) shall only be published on the website of **www.mptenders.gov.in only**. If holiday is declared by Govt. of M.P. on the date of opening, the same will automatically be shifted to subsequent working days.
MPRDC reserves the right to accept/reject any/all tenders without assigning any reason thereof.
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MANAGING DIRECTOR

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. DME/Diesel, Northern Railway, Diesel Loco Shed, Tughlakabad for and on behalf of President of India invites e-tenders for the following work .The tender will be accepted online only in the prescribed tender document.

Subject	Description
Name of Work	"Complete body cleaning, Cyclonic filters cleaning in 3-phase Electrical locomotives and Complete body cleaning, MIO type side body filters cleaning in conventional Electrical Locomotives at Diesel Shed Tughlakabad for 02 years."
Place of work	Diesel Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-110044.
Completion Period	02 Years
Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 11,70,900/-Including GST (Rupees Eleven Lakh Seventy Thousand Nine Hundred Only)
Amount of Bid Security	Rs. 23,400/- (Rs. Twenty Three Thousand Four Hundred only)
Technical Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Financial Eligibility Criteria	As per clause 10 of tender form (second sheet) of Tender Document.
Website to download and upload e-tender document	www.irops.gov.in
Due date & time of uploading of Tender by tenderer	18.06.2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date & Time of Tender opening	18.06.2026 after 12:00 Hrs.
Validity of offer	60 days from opening of tender.
Allocation	05-0511-32

Tender Document can be downloaded from Indian Railway website **www.irops.gov.in**. For details of work experience, scope of work and terms & conditions please see Tender document.
Tender Notice No. **DSL-TKD-Filter-OT-RT-26** Dated **27.05.2026** **1816/2026**

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CHANGE OF NAME

I, Rajiv Sharma S/o Late Kishan Lal Sharma R/o 24 D, MU Block, Pitampura, Delhi - 110034 have changed my name from Rajiv Kumar Sharma to Rajiv Sharma for all future purposes.
PD(1211)C
I, Sandhya Devi W/o No. 6496588A Hav Rajesh Kumar Yadav R/o- Vill & PO- Koni, Teh- Khalilabad, Dist- Sant Kabir Nagar, U.P- 272175, declare that in my husband's service records my D.O.B is wrongly written as 01/07/1956 whereas her correct D.O.B. is 01/01/1950 which may be amended accordingly.
PD(1214)C
I, Nidhi Devi W/o No. 14673750P Nk Pritam Kumar, R/o- Madhwa, PO- Lamahi, Dist- Varanasi, U.P.- 221007, have changed my name from Nidhi Devi to Nidhi Singh, vide affidavit dated 29/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.
PD(1215)C
I, Neha Kakkar D/O Suresh Kumar Kakkar, R/o B-1/155 Vishnu Garden, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018, have changed name of my minor son Aadvik to Aadvik Kakkar.
PD(1216)C

PD(1212)C
I, A Bharathi W/o- JC- 878730Y Sub (GMR) Simhachalam Ainam, R/o- 1-95, Gotiwada, PO- Subbavaram, Dist- Visakhapatnam, A.P- 531035, have changed my name from A Bharathi to Ainam Bharathi, vide affidavit dated 29/05/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.
PD(1213)C

Editor's
TAKE

TFR Drop: When progress
becomes a peril

India's fertility decline is a sign of progress.
Managing its consequences wisely will be the
real test of governance

It is irony at its finest. India has long been obsessed with its population – too many people chasing too few resources. Decades of family planning campaigns, incentives and occasional coercion were aimed at one goal: fewer births.

As the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) drops below sustainable levels, the real concern is no longer population explosion, but the consequences of falling fertility. The data now confirm that we have largely succeeded. But the big question that stares us in the face is: what happens next?

The latest estimates reveal that India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) has slipped well below comfortable levels. Urban India now records a TFR of just 1.5 – a number closer to ageing Japan than to a young, growing nation. Rural India holds steady at 2.1, precisely the replacement level, but that fragile equilibrium will not last long as urbanisation accelerates. The country that once feared a population explosion is quietly moving towards a population implosion, a trend seen in many developed nations.

The causes are neither mysterious nor uniquely Indian. Rapid urbanisation has compressed living spaces and inflated costs, making large families economically unviable. Women's rising educational attainment and workforce participation – unambiguously good things - have delayed marriage and childbearing. Access to contraception has improved dramatically. And perhaps most powerfully, aspirations have changed: urban couples increasingly invest heavily in one or two children rather than raising several. The shift from quantity to quality of offspring is a universal feature of development. India has simply reached that inflection point faster in its cities than anticipated.

A falling TFR is not, by itself, a crisis. The danger lies in the transition and in what it does to the age structure of society. Within a generation, India's celebrated demographic dividend – its vast working-age population - will begin to invert. A shrinking workforce will be asked to support a growing elderly population, placing pressure on pension systems, healthcare infrastructure and social security frameworks, which are already under strain.

The political consequences could be equally disruptive. India's federal system allocates parliamentary seats and central funds partly on the basis of population. States in the south and urban centres – which have controlled fertility the longest – stand to lose representation relative to states where TFRs remain higher. This threatens to deepen regional grievances.

India needs a smarter, three-pronged response. First, make parenthood less economically punishing through affordable childcare, housing subsidies for young families and flexible work policies. Second, build the social infrastructure for an ageing population now, not after the crisis arrives.

Third, revisit the political compact around delimitation, finding formulae that reward states for human development rather than penalising them for it.

India cannot afford ambiguity in West Asia

West Asia's instability now directly threatens India's energy security, maritime trade routes, economic interests,
and the safety of millions of Indians living across the Gulf



SHISHIR
PRIYADARSHI

West Asia has ceased to be a distant crisis zone that India can manage with cautious rhetoric and calibrated ambiguity. The Iran-Israel-US war has made the region's instability immediate, structural, and deeply relevant to India's energy security, maritime access, trade routes, and the safety of millions of Indians across the Gulf. That reality leaves New Delhi with a choice: adapt strategically or keep reacting to shocks it should have anticipated.

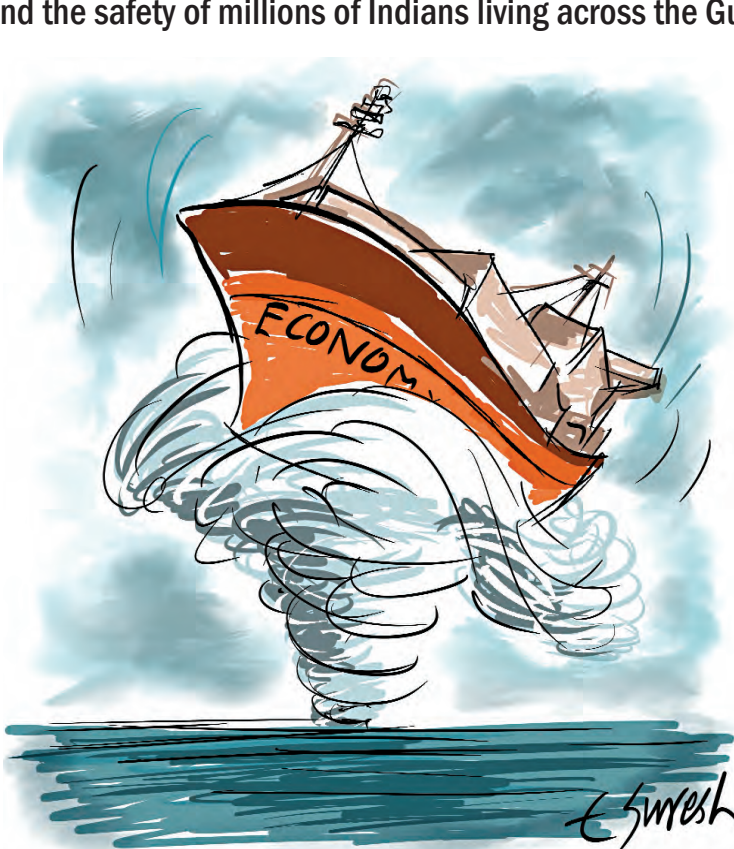
For too long, India's West Asia policy has relied on a familiar formula: engage everyone, offend no one, and let the region's storms pass around us. That formula worked when the region was volatile but still relatively containable. It is far less convincing now, because the conflict has exposed a more dangerous landscape: weakened states, competing external powers, new forms of warfare, and a regional order moving beyond old assumptions. India can no longer afford to think of West Asia as a background problem.

The old playbook is breaking

The first lesson of the war is that maximum pressure did not produce maximum results. The assumption that coercion, regime-change logic, and "shock and awe" could force Iran into political submission has not held up. Instead, the conflict has deepened instability and made the region less predictable. India should draw a hard conclusion from that failure: imported strategic theories do not guarantee regional order, and wishful thinking is not policy. That matters because India's own interests are tied to the region's stability in the most direct way possible. Energy corridors, shipping lanes, and trade routes are all exposed when West Asia convulses. So is the security of India's 10-million-strong diaspora. In a country that depends on imported energy and uninterrupted maritime access, these are not side issues. They sit at the core of national interest. The traditional "Look West" and "Link West" frameworks now face a genuine stress test. They were built for an era in which India could pursue steady ties across the region without being forced into sharper strategic choices. That era is over.

The region is more multipolar, more militarised, and more vulnerable to spillover than it was before. A serious power cannot keep using a lower-intensity foreign policy vocabulary in a higher-intensity environment.

This is where India must move beyond the comfort of balancing. Balance is useful; drift is



not been a passive observer; its background support to Iran and the benefits it draws from instability should be taken seriously. That does not mean India should overstate every move as part of a grand confrontation, but it does mean that Beijing's role should be understood as part of the wider contest over influence in West Asia.

Pakistan, by contrast, should not be allowed to distort the larger picture. Its role as a facilitator matters far less than whether diplomacy produces a workable peace. That is the right standard for India too. Diplomacy is not a zero-sum game. If a settlement reduces pressure and lowers the risk of escalation, India has an interest in that outcome regardless of who claims credit.

It is also important not to reduce West Asia to sectarian shorthand. The Shia-Sunni divide is often overplayed by Western commentators. The more important dynamic is competition for leadership, legitimacy, and strategic influence across the region. India's policy will be stronger if it is built on that reality rather than on simplistic labels that obscure more than they explain.

A better Indian line

There are signs that New Delhi has already begun to adjust. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visits to Israel and the UAE suggested a subtle recalibration in India's regional posture. Recent visits by India's National Security Adviser and External Affairs Minister to Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and Qatar point in the same direction. So does India's support at the BRICS foreign ministers' meeting in Delhi for a two-state solution on Palestine, including a reference to East Jerusalem. These are not trivial gestures. They indicate that India is trying to regain strategic credibility after a period in which its position looked less settled than before.

That effort is welcome, but it must not stop at symbolism. India has done well, so far, to secure its energy position better than many others. But short-term insulation is different from long-term strategy. New Delhi needs a more durable framework for crisis response, maritime protection, energy diversification, and regional engagement. It should plan for instability instead of assuming that instability will always remain manageable.

West Asia is now a test of whether India wants to act like a consequential power or merely a cautious one. The region touches India's economy, its diaspora, its sea lanes, and its diplomatic standing. That makes it central, not secondary. If India wants to shape the world around it, it must first show that it can read this region with clarity and respond with confidence. In West Asia, hesitation is also a choice, but it is becoming a costly one.



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not. India should certainly continue engaging all major regional actors, but it also needs to speak and act more clearly when its interests are at stake. A rising power cannot be content to look neutral while others shape the regional order around it. That means thinking harder about diplomacy, maritime security, and energy resilience at the same time. The war has become a laboratory for asymmetrical tactics and new military technologies, and those developments are redefining maritime and security risks in the wider region. India's free access to international waters cannot be treated as an abstract principle; it is a practical requirement that needs investment, planning, and deterrence.

India also needs to see itself, and be seen, as a stabilising force. As its economic and military weight grows, its diplomatic posture must grow with it. That does not mean seeking confrontation. It means being prepared to make principled, proactive interventions on issues that affect global supply chains, regional security, and the safety of Indian citizens. If India wants strategic respect, it must demonstrate strategic seriousness.

China, Pakistan and the real contest

The emerging landscape also requires a clearer reading of external actors. China has

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Why good people are quietly disappearing?



RAJYOGI
BRAHMA
KUMAR
NIKUNJ JI

2ND OPINION

We often hear of animal and bird species being declared endangered by governments and international organisations, leading to campaigns for their protection and conservation. Yet, very little attention is paid to another endangered species emerging in our times: the morally upright human being. In today's disturbed moral ecology, marked by corruption, crime, mental pollution and growing insensitivity, the ethically sound elite and morally strong middle class are slowly becoming a vanishing tribe. The drought in human compassion and the steady erosion of values have created a crisis far more dangerous than the extinction of wildlife.

This decline has not happened overnight. It has entered society quietly under attractive labels such as modernity, competition, success and personal freedom. In the

relentless pursuit of wealth, comfort and social visibility, people have compromised the principles that once gave strength to families, institutions and national character. Honesty is now often viewed as a weakness, while manipulation and opportunism are celebrated as intelligence. As a result, moral values that once shaped society have steadily lost their relevance in public life.

A major role in this transformation has been played by electronic and social media. Television, digital platforms and endless streams of entertainment dominate everyday life. The print media, too, is increasingly driven by sensationalism, conflict, celebrity gossip and "breaking news". Stories of integrity, sacrifice and moral courage rarely find space. One seldom reads about a businessman refusing a bribe, a teacher serving selflessly, or a doctor placing humanity above profit.

Educational and value-based content has become scarce, leaving readers vulnerable to shallow popular culture, propaganda and manipulative advertising.

Even in the world of books and magazines, commercial success often matters more than intellectual or moral enrichment. Publishers aggressively market material that entertains, shocks or excites because the market follows a simple rule: "What entertains well, sells well." A visit to any railway station bookstall reveals the trend clearly: sensational headlines, lurid covers and gossip packaged as journalism. Such material gradually

weakens society's appetite for ethical reflection and meaningful education.

This situation calls for urgent corrective measures. Society must consciously cultivate an interest in moral and spiritual values. The media, both print and electronic, should collaborate with educational and cultural institutions to promote ethical interpretations of events and issues. What is needed is not censorship, but conscience. People, especially the young and intellectually vulnerable, must be protected from becoming passive consumers of harmful content disguised as entertainment.

India once enjoyed immense respect among nations because of its moral and spiritual stature. Today, however, ethics appears increasingly absent from classrooms, clinics, courtrooms and boardrooms. Many believe that honesty and success cannot coexist. Those who firmly uphold moral principles despite heavy odds have become rare. Therefore, there is a pressing need to establish moral and spiritual centres across the country to preserve and promote ethical values. Just as wildlife sanctuaries protect endangered species, such centres can nurture people committed to integrity and inspire society at large. If action is not taken now, the extinction of moral character may become irreversible.

The writer is spiritual teacher and a popular columnist



PIC TALK

A peacock displays its plumage in Gurugram, Haryana.
PHOTO: PTI

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TRANSPARENCY NEEDED IN
CGHS PATIENTS' RIGHTS

The Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS) serves as a vital lifeline for millions of pensioners and government employees. However, there remains a persistent disconnect between the official policy guidelines formulated by the Ministry and the ground-level implementation within empanelled private hospitals. Far too often, hospitals conveniently "evade" or outright deny essential services-such as the issuance of mandatory medicines upon discharge, and the waiving of follow-up consultation fees for the initial visits. However, these are not mere suggestions. They are stipulated rights within the CGHS framework.

The current system relies on the patient having prior knowledge of these circulars, which creates an unfair power imbalance, where the patient or the caregiver who is

unaware of a specific provision is left vulnerable to being exploited by the hospital. One way to bridge this transparency gap is to issue a formal directive mandating all empanelled hospitals to display a standardised document that lists the rights of CGHS beneficiaries. This document should highlight key entitlements such as mandatory supply of medicines at the time of discharge, and beneficiaries, above 75 years of age, and free of cost follow-up consultations for initial visits post-discharge. By displaying this information within the hospital premises, the CGHS prioritises the ease and dignity of its beneficiaries by ensuring that their rights are visible, accessible, and non-negotiable, and can empower them to advocate for their rights in real-time.

MEERA JHANGIANI | GURUGRAM

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com.
In not more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The rise of a prodigy

The more you watch his batting style on the pitch, the more in awe you are left of Vaibhav Suryavanshi. It was surreal to watch players of the caliber of Pat Cummins and Heinrich Klaasen huddle together after each ball to this 15 year old kid, trying to fathom what to do next.

The teenage sensation produced his latest extraordinary innings by hitting 96 from just 29 balls to set up Rajasthan Royals' win over Sunrisers Hyderabad in the Indian Premier League eliminator.

The 15 year old struck twelve sixes, including three in a row off Australia captain Pat Cummins, before he was dismissed in the eighth over. It was an innings of brute power, exquisite timing, a good combination of hand-eye contact and scintillating stroke play of a power packed game.

The Rajasthan Royals opener also shattered a fourteen year old record, previously held by Chris Gayle of being the batter with the most sixes ever recorded in a single IPL season.

His prowess on the field matches that of legends like Sachin Tendulkar and his success augurs well for the future of Indian cricket. He has immense talent but how he nurtures it remains to be seen.

KRISHNAN SUBRAMANI | CHENNAI

Karnataka's political transition

The long power struggle within the Congress over Karnataka's leadership has resulted in Siddaramaiah relinquishing the Chief Minister's chair, with Deputy Chief Minister DK Shivakumar replacing him.

The task upon the Congress high command, now, is to avoid friction between the two factions and present a unified front to avoid the deeply entrenched trend in Karnataka's politics, which has not reelected the incumbent government since the 1980s.

A delicate balance must be struck between the two, as Siddaramaiah enjoys deep-rooted support among the minorities, backward classes, and the Dalits, while Shivakumar has organisational prowess that is second to none in Congress.

That's why Congress can neither afford to mishandle Siddaramaiah nor give too much indulgence to DK Shivakumar.

A key challenge for DK Shivakumar will be to maintain political stability within the state, ensure effective governance, while addressing public concerns, and balance party unity while meeting the expectations of different groups within the government. For Congress, DK Shivakumar is a gamble, for which they hope to see a return to power in the state in 2028.

BAL GOVIND | NOIDA

NEET needs an honest intent

Every year, lakhs of students set out to appear for one of India's most prestigious and highly competitive exams, NEET, with a dream to serve the nation as doctors.

Every year, repeatedly, their aspirations are shaken up by paper leaks, delays, and recently with the news of the Government considering militarising the way the exam is going to be conducted, with the defence forces managing the logistics and transportation for the NEET-UG 2026 re-exam scheduled for June 21, 2026. NEET is an annually scheduled civilian examination, not a border operation, and if the Education Ministry cannot conduct it without the army's help, then it is an admission of its institutional failure.

If an examination hall requires the same security as a sensitive zone, then the message communicated is that we do not trust our own systems. The National Testing Agency was constituted to be a body of professionals and yet today, its credibility is being protected by olive-green uniforms, not by reforms.

What NEET needs is not the military, but rather an honest intent-to digitize securely, plug the leaks and fix accountability from top to bottom.

BALARAM PARMAR | MADHYA PRADESH

The social erasure of domestic violence victims

Domestic violence is often sustained not only by abuse but by disbelief. Victims are frequently labelled, dismissed, and silenced, while their repeated cries for help go unheard, shifting attention away from accountability and towards questioning their credibility



HIMANJALI GAUTAM

In India, domestic violence is often not experienced as a single visible act of harm but as a prolonged process of emotional erosion followed by narrative control. What begins as private distress is frequently transformed into a public story about the victim's personality rather than the behaviour she is responding to. A woman who repeatedly raises concerns about emotional neglect, humiliation, or control is often met not with inquiry or support, but with minimisation. She may be told she is "overthinking", "too sensitive", or "mentally unstable". In more extreme cases, informal psychiatric labels such as "bipolar", "schizophrenic", or "crazy" are casually introduced into family conversations, not as clinical observations but as tools to weaken her credibility. In the context of ongoing public discussions around emotional abuse and psychological manipulation-reflected in cases like Twisha Sharma's-the pattern that emerges is not isolated to one case but indicative of a broader social system where disbelief often arrives before understanding, and where labels are used more quickly than listening.

A critical issue in such situations is that mental health terminology is frequently removed from its clinical foundation and used as a social weapon. In reality, psychiatric diagnoses can only be made by qualified mental health professionals after structured assessment, observation, and the application of recognised diagnostic criteria. However, in domestic disputes, these terms are often used informally to end uncomfortable conversations rather than to describe actual medical conditions. Statements like "she is schizophrenic" or "she is imagining things" are rarely grounded in clinical evaluation; instead, they function as rhetorical devices that shift attention away from the conduct being questioned and towards the supposed instability of the person raising the concern. Once this shift occurs, the conversation is no longer about harm or accountability, but about credibility. The victim's experience becomes secondary to the question of whether she can be trusted at all. This is where labelling becomes powerful-it does not need to prove anything; it only needs to create doubt.

Another recurring pattern is the consistent minimisation of abuse through the framing of it as a "family dispute" or a "difference of opinion". Such language appears neutral, even reasonable, but it often serves to depoliticise and privatise harm. When something is classified as a family matter, it is removed from scrutiny and external intervention. Victims are then encouraged to adjust, compromise, or remain silent in the interest of preserving family harmony. Phrases like "ghar ki baat bahar nahi jani chahiye" are frequently invoked, reinforcing the idea that maintaining the family's image is more important than addressing internal harm. While cultural emphasis on privacy is often framed as tradition, in practice it can operate as a mechanism of containment that discourages disclosure and protects existing power structures. In such environments, the cost of silence is borne disproportionately by the person experiencing distress, while the cost of acknowledgement is avoided by those responsible for the environment in which that distress arises.

Within this dynamic, repeated cries for help often go unacknowledged. Victims rarely remain silent from the beginning; instead, there are often multiple attempts to communicate discomfort, ask for support, or seek resolution. However, these attempts are frequently met with dismissal. The response is often to "adjust", "ignore it", or avoid escalation for the sake of family peace. Over time, this creates a pattern in which communication is met not with engagement but with deflection. The message becomes implicit: speaking will not change anything. In such circumstances, silence is not a choice but an outcome shaped by repeated invalidation. Yet, when the situation later becomes visible or reaches a breaking point, the same social environment often asks why the victim did not speak earlier. This contradiction overlooks the fact that speaking may have occurred repeatedly, but it did not lead to recognition or support. The failure lies not in communication alone, but in the absence of a response to that communication.

A particularly misunderstood consequence of prolonged emotional invalidation is reactive abuse. This refers to situations in which a person subjected to sustained



The Pioneer
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IN INDIA, DOMESTIC VIOLENCE IS OFTEN NOT EXPERIENCED AS A SINGLE VISIBLE ACT OF HARM BUT AS A PROLONGED PROCESS OF EMOTIONAL EROSION FOLLOWED BY NARRATIVE CONTROL. WHAT BEGINS AS PRIVATE DISTRESS IS FREQUENTLY TRANSFORMED INTO A PUBLIC STORY ABOUT THE VICTIM'S PERSONALITY RATHER THAN THE BEHAVIOUR SHE IS RESPONDING TO

The writer is a litigation attorney practising in New York. She is also a legal writer and has participated in media discussions and television debates

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psychological pressure, control, or humiliation eventually reacts with distress, anger, or an emotional breakdown. This reaction is then isolated from its context and used as evidence that the person is unstable, irrational, or abusive. What is often missing in public interpretation is the sequence of events: sustained emotional strain, repeated dismissal, lack of support, and eventual visible breakdown. The reaction becomes the focal point because it is observable, while the slow accumulation of distress remains invisible. In this way, the most visible moment of emotional collapse is often misinterpreted as the origin of the problem rather than its consequence.

Within this broader framework, labelling also serves a secondary function: it shields the accused from accountability. Once a victim is framed as unstable, attention shifts away from the behaviour she is describing. Instead of asking what happened, the focus becomes whether her account is reliable. This inversion is powerful because it changes the direction of inquiry. Harm is no longer investigated; perception is. The individual allegedly causing harm is indirectly protected by the instability attributed to the person reporting it. Over time, this dynamic can also lead to social isolation. Friends, relatives, or extended networks may withdraw, not necessarily out of malice, but because of confusion or fear of becoming involved in what is framed as a "complicated" situation. Isolation further weakens the victim's support system, making it more difficult to seek help or maintain confidence in her own perception of events.

Another important layer in contemporary contexts is the role of social media, which is often misunderstood as a transparent reflection of reality. In truth, social media represents fragments of life rather than its full emotional landscape. For individuals experiencing distress or abuse, it may function as an escape rather than a representation of stability. A curated photograph, a moment of laughter, or silence online does not necessarily indicate the absence of suffering. Similarly, emotional expressions online may represent only partial visibility of a much larger internal or relational reality. Assuming otherwise can lead to misjudgement, where appearance is mistaken for wellbeing and visibility is mistaken for truth. At the centre of this issue lies a persistent accountability gap. A more difficult but necessary question is often avoided: when a person repeatedly expressed distress, what response was provided by those closest to them? Partners and family members are not passive observers in such dynamics; they are part of the relational environment that either enables support or reinforces silence. Before concluding that someone is unstable, it becomes important to examine whether emotional support was consistently provided, whether concerns were acknowledged or dismissed, and whether professional help was encouraged responsibly or used as a form of control. In many cases, labelling replaces this inquiry altogether, allowing responsibility to be displaced rather than examined.

Ultimately, the issue extends beyond individual relationships to how society interprets distress and assigns credibility. When labels are used to silence rather than understand, and repeated cries for help are ignored, the system fails not only the victim but also the principle of accountability. The real question is not what was said about the victim, but why attempts to be heard were replaced with labels that were easier to accept than the truth.

And yes, an entire system fails when people remain silent while abuse is happening next door and is ignored simply because it is convenient.

Climate crisis: When comfort masquerades as immunity



ACHARYA PRASHANT

mental operation: the construction of a self that stands apart from its predicament.

The climate crisis has produced a version of this thought particularly well suited to the Indian urban professional class. It runs approximately as follows: climate change is real, regrettable, perhaps urgent, but its primary victims are the farmer without irrigation, the construction worker without shade, or the landless labourer whose livelihood is written entirely on the weather. These are people exposed in ways the urban professional is not. She has the air-conditioning, the subscription delivery service, the cab that comes to the door; in short, a cushion of affluence between herself and the conditions that devastate those who cannot purchase that cushion. The crisis is real; it is simply not hers.

The flaw in this reasoning is physiological, infrastructural, economic, and biological, and the evidence for it is not projected but already distributed through the middle class's own daily life. India has entered a heat season that scientists are describing in terms that would have seemed excessive a decade ago. Delhi's drainage infrastructure dates from 1976, when the city held six million people and the system was designed to handle 25 millimetres of rainfall per hour; the city now regularly receives more than double that in a single hour. The crisis the middle class has assigned to someone else is visible in the city's own property markets, its own seasonal calendar, its own streets after an hour of rain, and the exemption the middle class believes it holds has already been declined, though its holders have not yet checked the correspondence.

The air conditioner is one of the middle class's primary counter-arguments to the climate crisis: that affluence can purchase a private atmosphere, a set point of 23 degrees at which whatever happens outside becomes irrelevant. This is the ego's preferred relationship to shared consequence, the belief that what one has assembled around oneself constitutes a genuine separation from what one has produced.

The human body has exactly one mechanism for shedding internally generated heat: sweating, and the evaporation of sweat. Metabolism produces heat continuously; the body is, in thermal terms, an inefficient machine that generates more heat than work from everything it consumes. When humidity is high, sweat cannot evaporate, the skin cannot cool, and the body's core temperature rises until the organs most sensitive to heat, the brain foremost among them, begin to fail, and the failure is sudden rather than gradual. A healthy person sitting in the shade with unlimited water will lose consciousness and die when the wet-bulb temperature reaches 35 degrees, solely because the body's only heat-removal mechanism has been rendered inoperative by the moisture content of the surrounding air.

The air conditioner addresses this, as long as several simultaneous conditions hold: there is electricity, the unit is functioning within its operating range, the person is indoors, and the grid can carry the aggregate load of every unit in the city running at once during a heat emergency. When heat is severe enough to require cooling, every unit runs simultaneously, and the grid carries a load it was not designed to sustain.

Before the grid fails, the apartment must be exited anyway, because the apartment runs on labour from outside it. The domestic worker arrives each morning from a neighbourhood where power cuts run twelve to fifteen hours a day and the roof is tin, which turns a small room into an oven before noon. The delivery worker completing forty rides before noon, whose dark T-shirt shows a white outline of salt from what his body has spent in the heat, cannot be replaced by a platform algorithm that also operates in the same heat. The middle class's comfort is downstream of all of these labour chains, and when those chains degrade, the comfort degrades with them.

Through the winter months, air quality sits at AQI levels above 400, producing the metallic taste and sustained coughing that anyone who has spent a winter in Delhi recognises without being told. Come July, waterlogging closes parks, courts and outdoor spaces, while the standing water breeds dengue and chikungunya, diseases that the middle class contract alongside everyone else, with the same fevers, the same falling platelet counts, and the same hospital queues. A farmer in Uttar Pradesh reported this season that wheat grains are thinner and the harvest lighter than in previous years. The body receiving this food is itself not exempt from the atmospheric pressure it has been arranged to ignore. The human organism, in the most precise biological sense, is not a single entity: more than half the cells within a human body are microbial, belonging to communities of bacteria and fungi that govern digestion, immune response, and aspects of neurological function. When ambient conditions shift systematically across years and decades, those communities shift with them. The body that walks out of the air-conditioned apartment a decade from now carries a different internal biological arrangement from the one that walked out today, regardless of what the thermostat reads.

The exemption the middle class has arranged covers the ambient temperature of one room. It does not cover the food arriving in that room, the labour sustaining the supply chain, the grid powering the cooling, the social fabric outside the entrance, the rivers that will not always run, the soil producing the staples, or the body inhabiting the room and the microbiome the body is. The ego that wrote this exemption wrote it in a language the climate system has never learned.



Acharya Prashant is a philosopher and author whose work centres on self-inquiry and its application to contemporary life

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Hindi journalism@200: Power, polarisation and the loss of editorial Integrity



NEERAJ K SINGH

geous journalism in vernacular language. Over the past two hundred years, it has transformed into one of the most powerful media landscape across the world. Today, Hindi journalism has penetrated deeper into the social and political psyche of India than almost any other media tradition. It shapes the consciousness of the electorate, helps to define public morality, influences nationalism, and serves as a vital mediator between citizens and the state across northern Indian territories daily.

However, the immense growth of the Hindi media has not always been matched by a similar degree of boldness, autonomy, or democratic oversight. Indeed, the reverse often seems to be the case now. This is certainly not a problem concerning the language itself. Hindi remains a medium of public communication that continues to be incredibly dynamic and influential in India currently. Instead, this represents a crisis of technology, ethics, and structure. Digital transformations, troubled business models, and platform monopolies are immense challenges facing all journalistic traditions worldwide. Yet, there is a much

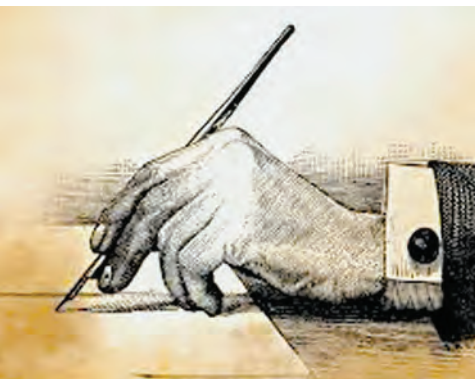
deeper crisis prevalent in certain sectors of the Hindi journalism that requires our immediate attention.

This internal crisis is fundamentally moral and structural. We are witnessing the shifting of public interest journalism into the realm of pure spectacle journalism. Accountability is frequently sacrificed in favour of remaining close to political power, as citizens are increasingly reduced into an emotionally manageable digital audience.

In its early days, Hindi journalism was never merely a business affair; it functioned as a vibrant, deeply committed intellectual and political movement across the nation. The early Hindi press viewed journalism as a profound democratic responsibility that could never be ignored under any circumstances by the writers and editors. Pioneers like Bharatendu Harishchandra utilised it for linguistic nationalism, whilst Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi championed fearless reporting against communal violence and state repression. Vidyarthi firmly established the stance that journalism must actively fight against oppression and injustice. Sadly, this moral clarity has slowly vanished over vast areas of the modern daily news landscape.

Economic liberalisation brought about a massive paradigm shift in the fundamental economics of the Indian media industry. The competition for audience attention, advertising revenue, and market share increased dramatically during the late twentieth century and beyond. Private television networks rapidly accelerated this massive transformation very significantly then.

The underlying logic of news had already



begun shifting in the year two thousand. Over time, journalism transitioned from a public institution into a commercial venture. In this metamorphosis, the Hindi media was uniquely susceptible due to the sheer size of its audience and the fierce competition within its regional markets. Today, editorial priorities can no longer be ignored, as commercial factors heavily influence it.

A vast majority of people now consume news via social platforms rather than through traditional institutional news outlets that were once highly respected universally. In this context, algorithms are exerting a powerful, indirect impact on editorial decisions by constantly promoting emotion, absolute certainty, extreme nationalism, and continuous confrontation. Newsrooms have ceased to function simply as mediums for delivering factual news. Instead, they actively fight for visibility in a digital age entirely predicated upon

engagement metrics.

This impact is exceptionally apparent within specific parts of the mainstream Hindi press industry, where debates are increasingly polarised. Often, television debates resemble an ideological theatre than a genuine journalistic inquiry. Emotionally charged binaries completely redraw complicated structural issues. The industry has discovered a highly efficient method for creating, spreading, and commercialising public outrage.

Over the last few years, the traditional vocabulary of democratic scrutiny has been steadily replaced by the loud vocabulary of permanent mobilisation. Media analysts have consistently highlighted the growing sensationalism, the tragic loss of public trust, and the normalisation of polarising content in Indian television news. This is not ideological diversity; it is the destruction of basic editorial integrity and genuine seriousness. This failure is most noticeable in what remains absent. The true problem with contemporary Hindi journalism is not merely what it magnifies, but also what it consciously ignores. Unless presented in a highly theatrical fashion, severe issues such as agrarian distress are seldom investigated.

Furthermore, issues including soaring unemployment, local governance failures, environmental degradation, and failing infrastructure are frequently neglected. Ground reporting has severely suffered, losing its foundational strength as the essential backbone of authentic regional journalism. Meanwhile, the relationship between various media houses and political power has undergone a complete metamorphosis. Historically, Hindi journalism derived its legitimacy from maintaining a

questioning attitude towards authority. Nowadays, cultivating proximity to power has increasingly become the standard business model. The space for adversarial journalism has shrunk considerably due to concentrated media ownership, massive reliance on government advertising, corporate consolidation, and heightened regulatory vulnerability overall. Internal censorship has thus become completely internalised within these traditional news institutions.

These vulnerabilities are further amplified by modern digital complexities. Whilst social media broadens engagement, it disperses authority. Organisations compete against propagandists, anonymous networks, and automated misinformation systems.

Consequently, being viral surpasses being verified. Prolonged exposure to emotionally charged environments diminishes civic tolerance for deliberation. However, excellent journalism continues within smaller, less metropolitan networks, surviving against formidable systemic odds.

The future credibility of Hindi journalism relies entirely upon regaining institutional trust, especially confronting deepfakes and tailored propaganda. As we reflect upon two centuries since *Udant Martand*, the press must challenge power, enlighten citizens, and assert public good. The best tribute to Hindi journalism is reflecting fearlessly on what it has become.

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Abdullah Azam jail term set aside in passport case

In a major relief for former MLA Abdullah Azam Khan, son of Samajwadi Party leader Mohammad Azam Khan, a court on Friday set aside the seven-year imprisonment he was sentenced to in the dual passport case. The MP-MLA Sessions Court accepted Khan's appeal nearly six months after he was sentenced by a magistrate court. In its order dated December 5, 2025, the magistrate court sentenced Khan to seven years in jail and imposed a fine of ₹50,000 on him. The case was registered in 2019 at the Civil Lines police station on a complaint filed by BJP leader Akash Saxena. The complaint alleged that Khan had obtained two passports using different dates of birth. Khan's counsel, Nasir Sultan, said Special Judge (MP-MLA Court) Dr Vijay Kumar allowed the former MLA's appeal and quashed the lower court order.



Zubeen case: Gauhati HC denies bail to key accused

The Gauhati High Court on Friday rejected bail to Shyamkanu Mahanta, the prime accused in the Zubeen Garg death case, noting that there is a "risk of fleeing and tampering evidence". After hearing arguments from both sides, a single-judge bench of Justice Mitali Thakuria denied bail to the accused. On April 30, a special fast-track court had rejected bail to Mahanta considering him as 'flight risk'. "The accused had challenged the trial court order of bail denial. The high court today rejected bail to Shyamkanu Mahanta after considering some crucial points," Assam Advocate General Devajit Saikia said at a press conference here. The high court noted that Mahanta is a 'flight risk' and there is a possibility of him absconding from the ongoing trial, he said. "He had earlier erased all his mobile data.



SC increases tenure of SCBA to two years, effective from 2027

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In wide-ranging electoral reforms, the Supreme Court on Friday increased the tenure of the executive committee of the Supreme Court Bar Association to two years while directing that the move would be effective from 2027.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice KV Viswanathan said there would be a one-year cooling-off period after completion of a term. The top court gave one additional month for conducting the SCBA elec-



tions to ensure implementation of the reforms, except for the increase in the executive committee's tenure.

The apex court also held that advocates who have made at least 50 appearances before it would be eli-



SC clears Vinesh for Asian Games 2026 trials

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday permitted wrestler Vinesh Phogat to participate in the selection trials to be held on May 30 and 31 for the Asian Games 2026.

A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe passed the order while hearing a plea filed by the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) challenging the Delhi High Court order allowing Phogat to participate in the selection trials.

"Today at this stage, the high court having passed the order, the hope and expectations have risen. To tell her to

go back home and we can't do anything, will not be proper. We are very bold in telling you this," the bench told the counsel appearing for the WFI. The top court said, "The respondent (Phogat) shall be permitted to participate in the selection trials for the Asian Games 2026 which are scheduled on May 30, 2026 and May 31, 2026."

The bench also expressed concern over the manner in which the high court dealt with the matter.

"We are not stopping. You (Phogat) go ahead and participate," it observed, adding that she has been an excellent wrestler and has made the country proud. During the



hearing, the bench asked senior advocate Madhavi Divan, who was appearing for Phogat, about the missed doping test and also about

the whereabouts part of it.

The top court said in December 2024, Phogat took a sabbatical saying that in August 2025, she would start

POCSO case: No SC relief against Swami's Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati bail

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday refused to interfere with the Allahabad High Court order granting anticipatory bail to Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati in a case registered against him under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

A bench of Justices MM Sundresh and N Kotiswar Singh dismissed the plea of complainant Ashutosh Brahmachari. Complainant Brahmachari argued that the high court failed to adequately consider the severity of the allegations against Avimukteshwaranand.

Advocate Saurabh Ajay Gupta, appearing for the complainant, submitted that Avimukteshwaranand had "sexually exploited" minors on the pretext of imparting education "It's a very heinous offence under the POCSO Act. The high court has dealt with the issue in a mechanical fashion," he submitted.

The bench, which questioned the petitioner over the delay in going to the police despite claiming to



have information about the alleged abuse of minors, said, "Sorry, we are not going to interfere". On March 25, the Allahabad High Court granted anticipatory bail to Avimukteshwaranand and his disciple Mukundanand Brahmachari in a case registered against them under the POCSO Act.

However, the high court restrained both the first informant and the applicants (Avimukteshwaranand and the disciple) from making any statements before the media in this regard.

The court had directed both of them to cooperate with the investigation.

The case pertains to an FIR lodged at the Jhansi police

station in Prayagraj following directions from a POCSO court, alleging sexual exploitation of several 'batuks' (young disciples) by the accused.

Avimukteshwaranand had maintained that the allegations were fabricated and his lawyers had contended before the high court that the complainant has a criminal history. They submitted that the seer has been falsely implicated in the case and claimed that the alleged victims never stayed at his ashram. The State had opposed the plea on technical grounds, saying it was filed directly in the high court without first approaching a sessions court.

Baba Siddique murder: MCOCA court denies bail to accused

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Mumbai

A special court on Friday refused bail to an accused in the Baba Siddique murder case, saying his role of harbouring the shooters is clearly supported by the material on record.

Nationalist Congress Party leader Siddique (66) was shot dead by three assailants outside his son Zeeshan's office in Mumbai's Bandra (East) area on the night of October 12, 2024.

Special MCOCA judge Satyanarayan R. Navander, in his ruling, noted that accused Amol Gaikwad was involved



in the activities of the organised crime syndicate, and his subsequent participation in harbouring the shooters connects him with the conspiracy hatched for com-

mitting the heinous offence.

His role cannot be said to be "less significant than that of the other accused persons in the syndicate", the court observed. Gaikwad had

sought bail on the ground that he was innocent and had been falsely implicated in the case.

Advocate Siddharth Agrawal, representing Gaikwad, argued that the investigating officer failed to comply with mandatory provisions of sections 47 and 48 of Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), making the arrest defective.

Additionally, the defence alleged Gaikwad's confessional statement was invalid as it was extracted under threats and pressure.

Special public prosecutor Mahesh Mule, as well as advocates Pradip Gharat and

Trivankumar Karnani, appearing for the victim's side, opposed Gaikwad's plea, contending that the applicant played a specific role in the conspiracy hatched for the murder of Baba Siddique. According to the prosecution, the specific role assigned to Gaikwad was to provide shelter to the shooters after the execution of the offence. The court, after considering the nature of the allegations, was of "the prima facie view that there is sufficient material indicating Gaikwad's involvement in the conspiracy and in facilitating the organised crime syndicate".

UP court defers hearing in case against AAP's Sanjay Singh



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Sultanpur (UP)

A Model Code of Conduct violation case hearing with AAP MP as one of the accused could not be held on Friday, as the investigating officer failed to appear in court.

Noting his absence, the MP-MLA court posted the matter for hearing on June 15. Sanjay Singh's counsel, Madan Pratap Singh, said that the investigating officer was required to appear today to record his statement, but he did not show up.

Before this, the investigating officer also failed to appear in court on May 21.

The case pertains to an election meeting allegedly held without permission in Hasanpur village under the Bandhua Kala Police Station jurisdiction during Uttar Pradesh panchayat polls on April 13, 2021.

SC extends TET deadline for teachers to August 31, 2028

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Friday reiterated that clearing the Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) is mandatory for in-service teachers and extended the time till August 31, 2028, for passing the exam to remain in service.

A bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Manmohan dismissed a batch of more than 65 review petitions filed by several state governments, teachers' associations and individual teachers challenging the

court's earlier ruling in the Anjuman Ishaat-e-Taleem Trust case.

The petitioners had sought reconsideration of the court's 2025 judgment, which held that in-service teachers appointed before the enactment of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act, 2009, and having more than five years left before retirement, must clear the TET within two years from September 1, 2025.

In an order, the court said, "TET examination must be conducted by the relevant



authorities expeditiously, as well as the time and resources required for the same are limited, we alter and extend the timeline from 2 to 3 years, the qualification has to be obtained by 31st August, 2028, instead of 31st August, 2027, as

originally directed". The court, however, made it clear that no further extension of time would be granted.

Rejecting the argument that the TET requirement amounted to retrospective application of the law, the

bench said the statutory framework of the RTE Act clearly envisaged that even in-service teachers were required to acquire minimum qualifications within a prescribed timeframe. The judgment noted that the RTE Act specifically dealt with teachers already in service at the commencement of the law and granted them time to obtain the prescribed qualifications.

"The legislature intended the in-service teachers to also meet the prescribed minimum threshold," the court said.

State cannot curtail individual's liberty: Supreme Court

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Underlining that the liberty of an individual cannot be curtailed by the State on account of slow bureaucratic processes, the Supreme Court on Friday awarded ₹11 lakh compensation to a man who was kept in illegal custody for 24 days despite the court issuing his release order.

A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and Augustine George Masih was hearing a plea filed by the man who was



sentenced to rigorous imprisonment of four years for rioting and house-tres-

pass by a court in Alwar, Rajasthan.

He applied for perma-

nent parole on December 3, 2023, but his plea was rejected on January 18, 2024. He later challenged the order before the Rajasthan High Court.

A single judge allowed his petition on November 5, 2024, and directed his release on furnishing a personal bond of ₹1 lakh and two sureties of ₹50,000 each.

By this time, he had already served 3 years, two months and 20 days of his four-year sentence.

By November 25, 2024, he had still not been released

despite complying with the conditions stipulated in the HC order. He then approached the Division Bench, which ordered his immediate release on December 6, 2024.

The man then moved the Supreme Court seeking compensation for illegal custody.

During the hearing on Friday, the top court quoted George Washington, the first US president, and said, "Arbitrary power is most easily established on the ruins of liberty abused to licentiousness."

Calcutta HC grants interim protection to actor Parambrata

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Calcutta High Court on Friday granted interim protection to actor Parambrata Chatterjee from any coercive step by the police over an alleged social media post by him following the 2021 West Bengal Assembly polls.

A written complaint was made on May 21 at Gariahat police station here, claiming that a social media post by Chatterjee on the day of declaration of the 2021 elections amounted to instigation and encouragement of post-poll violence, allegedly committed by unknown persons in different parts of the State.

Praying that the proceedings against Chatterjee be quashed, his lawyer stated before the court that the FIR does not attribute any overt act, criminal intention, or unlawful conduct to the petitioner. He said the FIR was lodged five years after the alleged social media post by the actor, maintaining that criminal liability cannot be fastened



based on speculative inferences drawn from a subjective or imaginative interpretation of words used in a communication.

Admitting the application for hearing, Justice Ajoy Kumar Mukherjee granted the actor interim protection from any coercive action by the police for four weeks.

Passing the ex-parte order, the court directed him to cooperate with the investigating agency. Justice Mukherjee clarified that the interim protection order will not prevent the investigating agency from submitting a final report, after completing the probe.

FROM THE WORLD

US

Indian-American journo honoured

Indian-American journalist T Vishnudatta Jayaraman, founder of South Asian Herald, was felicitated at the New York State Assembly. Jayaraman was presented with a proclamation by New York Assemblywoman Jenifer Rajkumar on Wednesday at the State Capitol in Albany. Rajkumar highlighted the work of South Asian Herald, calling it a “distinguished” news platform dedicated to covering the South Asian diaspora in the United States and an “important voice” for a “dynamic and influential community.” Speaker Pro Tempore Pamela Hunter, who presided over the session, wished Jayaraman and South Asian Herald “continued success.”

PAKISTAN

FM meets Marco Rubio

Pakistan’s Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar met US Secretary of State Marco Rubio here on Friday amid reports of the US and Iran closing in on an agreement to end the three-month war. Dar’s meeting with Rubio comes days after US President Donald Trump urged countries mediating the US-Iran talks to end the three-month war to join the Abraham Accords, which establish diplomatic, economic and security ties between Israel and Arab nations. Pakistan, which has emerged as a key mediator in the West Asia conflict, does not recognise the State of Israel and has no diplomatic relations with it.

India, US hold talks on Indo-Pacific security challenges

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Singapore

Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh met Commander of the US Indo-Pacific Command Admiral Samuel J Paparo in Singapore on Friday and held wide-ranging talks on security challenges in the region.

Singh’s talks with Paparo — on the sidelines of the Shangri-La Dialogue 2026 — focused on “strengthening military-to-military cooperation and addressing emerging security challenges” in the Indo-Pacific region, the Directorate of Public Relations under India’s Ministry of Defence said in a social media post.

The meeting reaffirmed

the “shared commitment” to deepening India-US defence ties at a time when the Indo-Pacific has emerged as the central theatre of global strategic competition, it said.

Earlier this week, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio noted that 60 per cent of global maritime trade passes through the Indo-Pacific, underscoring the region’s critical importance for Washington.

For India, the Indo-Pacific forms the core of its security calculus. The Indian Ocean flanks it on three sides — the Arabian Sea to the west, the Indian Ocean proper to the south, and the Bay of Bengal to the east. And it has growing strategic interests stretching from the Strait of



Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh with US Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM) Commander Admiral Samuel J Paparo during a meeting on the sidelines of Shangri-La Dialogue 2026 in Singapore

Malacca to the Persian Gulf.

The development comes days after India hosted the Quad foreign ministers’ meeting in New Delhi, where External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, along with his counterparts from the US, Australia and Japan, announced the grouping’s first-ever joint infrastructure project — a port in Fiji.

The Quad also launched an Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Cooperation Initiative, aimed at establishing a Common Operating Picture and sharing near-real-time data across strategic shipping lanes.

On the sidelines of the Singapore summit, Singh also held separate meetings with Admiral Giuseppe Cavo

Dragone, who heads the NATO Military Committee, Canada’s Senior Associate Deputy Minister of National Defence Kelvin Brosseau, and Seychelles’ Chief of Defence Forces Major General Micheal Rosette. Defence collaborations and security challenges were some of the common themes of these meetings, according to the Ministry of Defence. Singh also addressed a gathering of leading think tanks and academia, where he shared India’s vision for regional security and strategic engagement.

The flurry of engagements comes in the context of a broader visit to Singapore that has seen Singh undertake a packed schedule of defence diplomacy.

Good governance, development national need: Nepal President

SHIRISH B PRADHAN
■ Kathmandu

Nepal President Ramchandra Paudel on Friday urged political parties, civil society and other stakeholders to contribute to developing a well-cultured and prosperous society as envisaged by the Constitution.

The Constituent Assembly declared Nepal as a federal democratic republic on 15 Jeshtha 2065 Bikram Samvat (May 28, 2008), formally abolishing the 240-year-old monarchy in the country.



Addressing a special ceremony at Tundikhel in Kathmandu on the occasion of Nepal’s 19th

Republic Day, President Paudel emphasised that realising the objectives of good governance, development and prosperity is today’s national need.

This can be accomplished by strengthening an accountable and people-oriented service delivery, he said. President Paudel was speaking on the occasion as Prime Minister Balendra Shah declined to address the ceremony at Tundikhel, ending a long-standing tradition of the elected prime minister delivering the keynote speech.

Rail car fire near New York’s Penn Station injures five

ASSOCIATED PRESS
■ New York

A fire in a rail yard train car near New York’s Penn Station injured five people and disrupted service for many commuters early on Friday, authorities said.

The fire resulted in train delays in New Jersey Transit

and Amtrak rail service into New York and briefly suspended Long Island Rail Road service, more than a week after a strike had shut down that system.

New Jersey Transit posted on X that it was an Amtrak train car that was on fire “in one of the Hudson River tunnels.” It said the fire result-



School fire: Kenyan police arrest 8 students

EVELYNE MUSAMBI
■ Nairobi

Kenyan police arrested eight female students on suspicion of arson, authorities said Friday, after a fire destroyed a dormitory at a boarding school, killing 16 children and injuring dozens of others.

The motive remains under investigation.

The girls were arrested for planning and carrying out a suspected arson attack at Utumishi Girls School in central Kenya, according to the Directorate of Criminal Investigations, or DCI, a department of the national



police. In addition to the deaths, the blaze on Thursday morning left 79 others injured.

Police spent the whole day Thursday questioning

30 students at the school and asked their parents to head home without the girls and come back on Friday morning. “Investigators have conducted extensive inter-

views with students, teaching staff and other witnesses, while forensic teams carry out a detailed review of available CCTV footage,” DCI spokesperson John Marete said in a statement.

Education Minister Julius Ogamba said Friday the school’s board of management had been dissolved and the principal would face disciplinary action for failing to comply with the safety manual.

“In particular, there was congestion in the dormitory and one exit door was locked, contrary to the prescribed safety requirements,” he said. (AP)

Philippine court orders senator’s arrest for large-scale corruption



JIM GOMEZ ■ Manila

A Philippine anti-graft court ordered the arrest of a prominent senator on Friday over allegations he pocketed a kickback of millions of dollars in a flood-control project, in the latest crisis to entangle the Senate.

Sen Jinggoy Estrada surrendered and posted bail before the Sandiganbayan court, allowing him to remain free while the case proceeds.

The court barred Estrada from leaving the country while facing the first of two corruption-related charges in relation to the flood control project anomalies.

Another warrant for his arrest for the second charge, which is non-bailable, is expected to be issued by the court soon,

top anti-graft prosecutor Jesus Crispin Remulla told The Associated Press. Estrada, 63, has strongly denied allegations mainly by a former Government public works engineer that he received more than 570 million pesos (\$9.3 million) in kickbacks. “I intend to

avail myself of every lawful means to defend myself and clear my name,” Estrada said. The senator was an actor like his father, former President Joseph Estrada. Both have been previously detained on other corruption-related charges.

Several other senators and members of the House of Representatives have been implicated in the flood control anomalies in a poverty-stricken Asian archipelago that is among the most vulnerable to deadly floods and typhoons.

Another senator, Ronald dela Rosa, has gone into hiding after the International Criminal Court issued a warrant for his arrest for an alleged crime against humanity.

Dela Rosa was a former national police chief who enforced a brutal anti-drugs crackdown under then-President Rodrigo Duterte that left thousands of mostly petty suspects dead. The unprecedentedly large numbers of killings alarmed Western governments. (AP)

Hormuz exposes China’s Indian Ocean vulnerability

GURDIP SINGH ■ Singapore

China’s maritime vulnerability begins at the Strait of Hormuz rather than the Strait of Malacca, creating a new arena of strategic competition in the Indian Ocean among Beijing, India, France and the US, according to a report by the London-based International Institute of Strategic Studies.

Released ahead of the three-day Shangri-La Dialogue security summit that opened in Singapore on Friday, the report says the Indian Ocean Region is re-emerging as a key strategic theatre after decades of relative calm following the end of the Cold War.

The report, titled “Asia Pacific Regional Security Assessment”, argues that China’s dependence on



energy supplies moving through the Indian Ocean has made the region increasingly important to Beijing’s security calculations, while also exposing vulnerabilities that rival powers could seek to exploit during a conflict. The study examines strategic competition around major maritime choke points linking the Middle East and Asia, with particular focus on the Strait of Hormuz and the Straits of Malacca and Singapore (SOMS), also known as the Malacca Strait, which carries a substantial share of global energy shipments. (PTI)

ReNew Solar Energy (Jharkhand Five) Private Limited					
CIN : U40300DL2015PLC275651					
Regd. Office : 138, Ansal Chambers II, Bikaji Cama Place, Delhi-110066					
Corporate Office : ReNew.hub, Commercial Block-1, Zone-6, Golf Course Road, DLF City Phase-V, Gurugram, 122009, Haryana, Phone – 0124-4896 670/ 80					
Statement of Audited Financial Results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026					
Particulars	Quarter ended	Quarter ended	Quarter ended	Year ended	Year ended
	31 March	31 December	31 March	31 March	31 March
	(Refer note 8)	(Unaudited)	(Refer note 8)	(Audited)	(Audited)
Total Income from Operations	2,18,426	2,27,509	2,45,657	9,39,004	8,75,039
Net (Loss)/ profit (before tax, exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	10,314	21,455	41,550	95,221	85,158
Net (Loss)/ profit before tax (after tax, exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	10,314	21,455	41,550	95,221	85,158
Net (Loss)/ profit after tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	17,990	31,094	26,064	1,26,699	3,968
Total comprehensive (loss)/income [comprising profit / (loss) (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)]	17,990	31,094	26,064	1,26,699	(49,233)
Paid up Equity Share Capital	57,740	57,740	57,740	57,740	57,740
Reserves (excluding revaluation reserve)	8,83,931	8,64,536	7,57,232	8,83,931	7,57,232
Net worth	9,41,671	9,22,276	8,14,971	9,41,671	8,14,971
Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding debt Debt Equity Ratio*	68,90,427	69,63,932	71,94,133	68,90,427	71,94,133
Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)	9.79	8.43	8.87	9.79	8.87
1. Basic (In INR)	3.12	5.39	4.51	21.94	0.69
2. Diluted (In INR)	3.12	5.39	4.51	21.94	0.69
Debtenture Redemption Reserve (In INR thousands)	2,37,530	96,563	3,969	2,37,530	3,969
Debt Service Coverage Ratio*	0.56	0.63	0.61	0.61	0.75
Interest Service Coverage Ratio*	1.30	1.36	1.48	1.38	1.62
Current ratio	8.33	8.28	8.64	8.33	8.64
Long Term Debt to Working Capital	1.90	1.91	1.94	1.90	1.94
Current Liability Ratio	0.06	0.06	0.06	0.06	0.06
Bad debt to Accounts Receivable Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Total Debts to Total Assets Ratio	0.84	0.84	0.86	0.84	0.86
Debtors Turnover Ratio*	2.05	2.00	2.28	7.44	8.61
Inventory Turnover Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Operating margin (%)	67%	69%	74%	67%	67%
Net profit margin (%)	11%	20%	15%	19%	1%
Security Coverage ratio	1.15	1.18	1.16	1.15	1.16
*Not annualized					
Disclosures pursuant to Regulations 52(4), 54(3) and 63(2) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as amended) (standalone) :					
Notes :					
1. Ratios have been computed as follows :					
- Earning per share = Profit after tax / Weighted average number of equity shares					
- Debt Equity Ratio = Debt (Amount due to Debenture Holders) / Equity (Equity share capital, share premium, loan from Related party and excluding unamortized fees)					
- Interest Service Coverage Ratio* = Profit before interest, tax and depreciation / Total Interest Expense.					
- Current Ratio = Current Assets/ Current Liabilities					
- Long Term Debt to Working Capital = Non- Current borrowing including current maturities of Non-current borrowings/ (Current Assets - Current Liabilities excluding current maturities of Non-Current borrowings)					
- Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio = Bad debts / Average Trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue					
- Current Liability Ratio = Current Liabilities/ Total Liabilities					
- Total Debts to Total Assets = Total outstanding debts/ Total Assets					
- Debtors turnover= Revenue from operation/ Average trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue					
- Inventory Turnover- The company does not generate revenue from selling of inventory, hence this ratio is not applicable.					
- Operating margin(%)= (Profit before tax + Finance costs - Other income)/ Revenue from operations					
- Net Profit Margin (%) = Net profit after Tax/ Revenue from Operations					
- Debt Service Coverage Ratio* = Earnings before interest tax and depreciation + non cash expense -taxes paid- non cash other income- interest on loan from related party/ Fixed interest + Redemption Instalments + other financing costs					
*As per Debenture Trust Deed dated 26 August 2024 (as amended).					
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly and yearly financial results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under regulation 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly and half yearly financial results is available on the website of Bombay Stock Exchange of India Limited and the listed entity (URLs https://www.bseindia.com)					
3. For the other line items referred in Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to the Bombay Stock Exchange of India Limited and can be accessed on the URLs https://www.bseindia.com					
4. The statement has been prepared in accordance with recognition and measurement principles laid down in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standard prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 (‘the Act’) read with Rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 and relevant rules issued thereunder and other recognized accounting practices and policies.					
5. The company is in the business of renewable power generation and other ancillary activities via solar power plant. There are no separate reportable segments (business and/or geographical) in accordance with the requirements of IND AS - 108 ‘Operating Segments’ and hence there are no additional disclosures to be provided other than those already provided in the financial statements.					
6. The above financial results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026 have been approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at the meeting held on 29 May 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out the audit for financial results of the Company for the period and year ended 31 March 2026.					
7. Care Ratings has assigned long term issuer rating and rating for the outstanding non-convertible debentures of the Company to ‘‘CARE AA’’ with stable outlook.					
8. The figures of the quarter ended 31 March 2026 and 31 March 2025 are the balancing figures between audited figures for the full financial year ended 31 March 2026 and 31 March 2025 and the unaudited figures to the date figures upto the third quarter of the respective financial year.					
For and on behalf of the					
ReNew Solar Energy (Jharkhand Five) Private Limited					
Place : Gurugram	(Sd/-) Deepak Gupta	(Sd/-) Sivaprasad Manikkapurath			
Date : 29 May, 2026	Director, DIN : 01812112	Director, DIN : 09621419			

ReNew Wind Energy (Jath) Limited					
CIN No. U40101DL2012PLC236227					
Regd. Office : 138, Ansal Chambers II, Bikaji Cama Place, Delhi-110066					
Corporate Office : ReNew.hub, Commercial Block-1, Zone-6, Golf Course Road, DLF City Phase-V, Gurugram, 122009, Haryana, Phone – 0124-4896 670/ 80					
Statement of Audited Financial Results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026					
(Amounts in INR millions, except share and per share data, unless otherwise stated)					
Particulars	Quarter ended 31 March 2026	Quarter ended 31 December 2025	Quarter ended 31 March 2025	Year ended 31 March 2026	Year ended 31 March 2025
	(Refer note 6)	(Unaudited)	(Refer note 6)	(Audited)	(Audited)
Total Income from Operations	135	124	137	890	860
Net (Loss)/ Profit for the year (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	(17)	(25)	(19)	290	164
Net (Loss)/ Profit for the year before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	(17)	(25)	(17)	290	290
Net (Loss)/ Profit for the year after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	(13)	(20)	(9)	216	118
Total Comprehensive Income for the year [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	(13)	(20)	(13)	216	216
Paid up Equity Share Capital	153	153	153	153	153
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	2,153	2,166	1,937	2,153	1,937
Securities premium	1,366	1,366	1,366	1,366	1,366
Net worth	2,306	2,319	2,090	2,306	2,090
Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	1,588	1,767	1,939	1,588	1,939
Debt Equity Ratio	0.92	1.02	0.92	0.92	0.98
Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)					
1. Basic :	(0.86)	(1.29)	(0.57)	14.13	14.13
2. Diluted :	(0.86)	(1.29)	(0.57)	14.13	14.13
Debtenture Redemption Reserve	122	137	143	122	122
Debt Service Coverage Ratio*	0.40	7.24	0.30	1.21	0.98
Interest Service Coverage Ratio*	1.54	1.36	2.67	3.23	2.43
Current ratio*	1.00	0.99	2.23	1.00	2.23
Long Term Debt to Working Capital*	1.01	1.02	1.30	1.01	1.30
Current Liability Ratio*	0.81	0.83	0.32	0.81	0.32
Total Debts to Total Assets Ratio*	0.32	0.34	0.39	0.32	0.39
Debtors Turnover Ratio*	0.89	0.39	1.03	8.16	7.19
Inventory Turnover Ratio*	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Operating margin (%)	(39%)	1%	(23%)	50%	38%
Net profit margin (%)	(19%)	(21%)	(12%)	30%	17%
Disclosures pursuant to Regulations 52(4) and 52(7) Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.					
Notes :					
1. Ratios have been computed as follows :					
- Earning per share = Profit after Tax / Weighted average number of equity shares					
- Debt Equity Ratio* = Debt (Amount due to Debenture Holders) / Equity (Equity share capital, share premium, loan from Related party and excluding unamortized fees)					
- Interest Service Coverage Ratio* = Profit before interest, tax and depreciation / Total Interest Expense.					
- Current Ratio= Current Assets/ Current Liabilities					
- Long Term Debt to Working Capital= Non- Current borrowing including current maturities of Non-current borrowings/ (Current Assets - Current Liabilities excluding current maturities of Non-Current borrowings)					
- Bad debts to Accounts Receivable ratio= Bad debts / Average Trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue					
- Current Liability Ratio= Current Liabilities/ Total Liabilities					
- Total Debts to total Assets* = Total outstanding debts/ Total Assets					
- Debtors turnover= Revenue from operation/ Average trade receivables and Average unbilled Revenue					
- Inventory Turnover- The company does not generate revenue from selling of inventory, hence this ratio is not applicable.					
- Operating margin(%)= (Profit before tax + Finance costs - Other income)/ Revenue from operations					
- Debt Service Coverage Ratio* = (PAT based on Project Revenues realised (excluding non-cash adjustments, if any)**+ Depreciation+ Interest (Interest, Guarantee Fees, other financing costs payable under Debenture and Project Documents)) / (Interest + Principal Repayment+Guarantee fee).					
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under regulation 52 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly financial results is available on the website of National Stock Exchange of India Limited and the listed entity (URLs https://www.nseindia.com & https://www.renew.com/renew-wind-energy-limited-jath/).					
3. For the other line items referred in Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, the pertinent disclosures have been made to the National Stock Exchange of India Limited and can be accessed on the URLs https://www.nseindia.com & https://www.renew.com/renew-wind-energy-limited-jath/).					
4. The statement has been prepared in accordance with recognition and measurement principles laid down in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standard 34 'Interim Financial Reporting' ("Ind AS 34") as prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 ("the Act") read with Rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 and relevant rules issued thereunder and other recognized accounting practices and policies.					
5. The company is in the business of development and operation of wind power. There is only one segment (business and/ or geographical) in accordance with the requirements of IND AS - 108 'Operating Segments'.					
6. The figures of the quarter ended 31 March 2026 and 31 March 2025 are the balancing figures between audited figures for the full financial year ended 31 March 2026 and 31 March 2025 and the published year to the date figures upto the third quarter of the respective financial year.					
7. The above standalone financial results have been approved by the board of directors in the respective meeting held on 28 May 2026.					
8. India Ratings and Care Ratings has assigned long term issuer rating and rating for the outstanding non-convertible debentures of the Company to "IND AA (CE)" with negative outlook and "CARE AA (CE)" with stable outlook, respectively.					
For and on behalf of the ReNew Wind Energy (Jath) Limited					
(Sd./) Ravinder Singh					
Additional Director, DIN : 11320393					
Place : Gurugram					
Date : 28 May, 2026					

India-EAEU trade liberalisation talks intensified, says Putin

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Astana

Russian President Vladimir Putin has said that negotiations on trade liberalisation between the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) and India have intensified, signalling fresh momentum in efforts to forge a free trade agreement between the two sides, according to a media report.

"Last year trade agreements were concluded with Mongolia and the United Arab Emirates, as well as with Indonesia, intensifying negotiations on trade liberalisation with India," Putin was quoted as saying at the Supreme Eurasian Economic Council in Kazakhstan's capital Astana on Friday, by Russian state-owned TASS news agency.



Russian President Vladimir Putin, left, speaking to Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov at the Supreme Eurasian Economic Council summit at the Independence Palace in Astana, Kazakhstan on Friday

The EAEU is a five-member economic bloc comprising Russia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Armenia. It was founded in 2015 to promote economic integration through a common

market, the elimination of trade barriers and the coordination of economic policies among its member states. "We support the draft decisions on launching talks on free trade agree-

ments with new promising partners," said Putin, adding that all aspects of such forward movement would be carefully analysed.

The India-EAEU free trade agreement (FTA) process has been gaining ground steadily. In August 2025, India and the EAEU signed the Terms of Reference to formally launch FTA negotiations, with both sides noting that bilateral trade turnover had reached \$69 billion the previous year, registering a seven per cent increase over 2023.

The first round of negotiations was held from November 26 to 28 last year. The talks gained further momentum this year with New Delhi identifying deeper trade integration with the EAEU as one of its priorities under its BRICS chairmanship.

HUNGARY'S MAGYAR MEETS WITH EU LEADERSHIP IN BRUSSELS



JUSTIN SPIKE/SAM MCNEIL
■ Brussels

Hungarian Prime Minister Peter Magyar will meet Friday for the first time since taking office with European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen in Brussels in a bid to unlock billions of euros frozen over the democratic backsliding of his predecessor.

Partly by campaigning on forging stronger ties with the European Union, Magyar's earthquake success in the April election ended the 16-year rule of Viktor Orban, who had vilified von der Leyen and other powerbrokers in the 27-nation bloc as he hollowed out institutional checks and balances in Hungary.

Those actions, and concerns over corruption and the erosion of judicial independence under Orban, prompted the bloc to freeze the billions in funding to Budapest in 2022.

A year later, the commission found that the government had carried out sufficient reforms to have around 10.2 billion euros (\$12.1 billion) released. After Magyar's party Tisza won a super-majority in parliament, which will enable deep and quick reforms, leaders in both Brussels and Budapest prioritised releasing the funds as soon as possible to help Hungary's slumped economy.

The funds are split between 10 billion euros of COVID recovery funds and 6.3 billion euros in the cohesion funds designed to lift up struggling economies within the EU.

The teams from Brussels and Budapest are working to first unlock the COVID funds because they are set to expire in August.

Carney calls for new partnership with US

ROB GILLIES ■ Toronto

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney called for a new partnership with the United States on Thursday, just weeks before President Donald Trump decides on whether to renew the free trade agreement between the countries.

Carney said in a speech at the Economic Club of New York that there should be a "true partnership" that reimagines cooperation in specific sectors challenged by global competition.

He made the remarks ahead of the mandatory review of United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement, or USMCA, in July. Carney said Canada is diversifying away from the US and signing trade deals with dozens of countries around the world.

"Our core objective across these partnerships is to increase our strategic autonomy. Because we live



in a world where integration has been weaponised. Because a country that cannot feed, fuel or defend itself is not truly sovereign," Carney said. Trump's actions -- including launching a trade war and suggesting Canada become the 51st US state -- have infuriated Canadians and created the political environment for Carney to win the job of prime minister after promising to confront Trump.

The Canadian prime minister has emerged as a spokesman for a move-

ment for countries to find ways to link up and counter the US under Trump. Carney has set a goal for Canada to double its non-US exports in the next decade, saying American tariffs are causing a chill in investment.

"Canada Strong will help make America great again. The examples are legion where we should work together and compete with the world together. And to those ends, we have made specific, practical proposals to the US administration," Carney said.

Guatemala President denies US anti-drug strike deal

ASSOCIATED PRESS
■ Guatemala City

Guatemalan President Bernardo Arevalo denied the existence of an agreement with the United States to conduct anti-drug trafficking operations on Guatemalan soil.

The comments come after The New York Times reported that the Central American nation agreed to carry out joint strikes. The case is the latest in ongoing tensions between the Trump administration and Latin American Governments that seek to

involving soldiers on Guatemalan soil is the Congress of the Republic. The Guatemalan government is not requesting this cooperation and has no plans to do so," the president said.

When asked about the supposed agreement, acting Pentagon press secretary Joel Valdez said he cannot "speculate on future operations or discuss matters of operational security" but emphasised that the Department of War works with partners in the region to fight drug trafficking and other



strike a balance between bilateral cooperation to fight drug trafficking and maintaining sovereignty.

"There is no agreement. There is a request that falls within the framework of existing agreements in several countries," Arevalo said at a news conference.

"What we are signing are types of collaboration that have been taking place in the past. We conduct maritime interdictions where the United States has been collaborating with training, capacity building and equipment," Arevalo said.

He said the Government's actions are in accordance with Guatemalan law and the Constitution.

"The only body that can authorise operations

transnational threats.

The Guatemalan government also published a press release and two letters in which its defence minister discusses combined military operations under pre-existing agreements with US Secretary of War Pete Hegseth.

The April deaths of two CIA agents in northern Mexico after an operation to destroy a drug lab highlighted the presence of US agents in Latin America and raised questions about heightened US involvement throughout the region. In the days following, Mexican officials offered contradictory accounts on how much information the country had regarding the CIA agents' involvement.

Colombians to vote on Sunday in high-stakes test for President Petro

MANUEL RUEDA ■ Bogota

Colombia will elect a new president and vice president in a vote on Sunday that has been cast as a referendum on outgoing President Gustavo Petro's policies.

A former member of Colombia's M-19 guerrilla group, which fought for social justice in the 1970s and '80s, Petro has undertaken controversial peace negotiations with the country's remaining rebel groups, while pushing for social and economic reforms that include an overhaul of the nation's labour laws.

He also has broken with previous Colombian leaders in his approach to foreign affairs by challenging the United States in areas like anti-drug policy and immigration, while maintaining some co-operation with the Trump administration on these matters.

The fate of these policies hangs in the balance as voters head to the polls, testing Petro's assertion that "the people will decide if the revolution is defeated or if it moves forward". Here is what to know about Colombia's presidential election. Candidates emerge from a field of 14. There will be 14 candidates on the ballot, but the election has basically turned into a three-horse race.

Colombia's constitution bars Petro from seeking reelection. His party, the Historical Pact, will be represented by Ivan Cepeda, 63, a three-term senator known for defending the victims of



President Gustavo Petro's

State crimes during Colombia's decades-long conflict.

One of Cepeda's main rivals is Abelardo de la Espriella, 47, a bombastic lawyer nicknamed "The Tiger" who is running as an independent and has cast himself as an outsider. He claims he is running for the presidency without the support of any of the nation's main political parties.

De la Espriella's high-profile clients have included business owners accused of money laundering, a sex worker who denounced illegal conduct by US Secret Service agents and an acid-attack survivor whose case inspired legislation that heavily penalises these kinds of attacks, which are usually waged against women. Another candidate with considerable support is Paloma Valencia, 48, a senator who represents the Democratic Centre, the party led by influential former President Alvaro Uribe.



The Italian aerobatic squadron Freccia Tricolori or Tricolor Arrows, flies over the Piazza di Siena International Horse Show before the start of the CSIO Nations Cup competition in Rome on Friday

Indian-owned companies in UK surge in record investment year: Report

ADITI KHANNA ■ London

The number of Indian-owned companies in the UK surged by nearly 60 per cent year-on-year to rise to 1,912 with a combined turnover of 105.77 billion pounds, according to the 'India Meets Britain Tracker 2026'.

The latest edition of the annual Grant Thornton-led analysis of Indian investment and economic impact in the UK was launched by Indian High Commissioner to the UK P Kumar in London on Thursday.

The 2026 Tracker reflects

a significant increase from the 1,197 Indian-owned firms generating around 72.14 billion pounds in 2025, as well as a jump in employee numbers from 126,720 last year to 203,549.

"The India-UK relationship today is no longer defined by nostalgia; it is defined by opportunity," said Kumar, in one of his first addresses as the new High Commissioner.

"India brings scale, growth, talent, and ambition, and the United Kingdom brings innovation, expertise, finance, and global leadership across



advanced sectors, and together we have the chance to build one of the defining economic partnerships of the coming

decades," he said.

The 2026 Tracker notes that bilateral trade between India and the UK rose to 47.4 billion pounds in 2025,

an 11.7 per cent year-on-year increase during the year which marked the signing of the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA).

"With CETA now in place, the India-UK corridor is poised for unprecedented growth, creating value for both economies and cementing a long-term partnership," said Anuj Chande, Grant Thornton Partner and Head of South Asia Business Group.

"We are continuing to see that the India-UK corridor is not just a trade

relationship; it is a strategic partnership leveraging innovation, resilience, and shared ambitions.

"With nearly all Indian mid-market firms planning UK expansion and UK businesses eyeing India for growth, this collaboration is set to thrive in the coming years across technology, clean energy, and advanced manufacturing," he said.

The implementation of CETA is expected to inject further momentum into bilateral trade and investment ties once it takes effect in the coming months.

Ex-head monk of China's Shaolin Temple sentenced to 24 years

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Beijing

Shi Yongxin, former head priest of China's Shaolin Temple, who played a significant role in popularising kung fu around the world, was on Friday sentenced to 24 years in prison under graft charges, official media reported.

Shi was convicted of crimes including duty encroachment, embezzlement of funds and bribery, according to the Intermediate People's Court of Xinxiang City in central China's Henan Province, state-run Xinhua news agency reported. He was also fined 3.5 million yuan (\$516,000). The monk



was sacked and detained in July last year for violating Buddhist precepts.

The violations included maintaining long-term, improper relationships with multiple women and fathering illegitimate children.

Netanyahu cites India's crazy love for Israel



HARINDER MISHRA ■ Jerusalem

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has described India as a "huge power" where there is "an absolutely crazy love for Israel" despite what he called efforts to delegitimise the Jewish state elsewhere.

Speaking at a leadership programme in the Jordan Valley on Thursday, Netanyahu further cited India as a key example of Israel's expanding international partnerships, as he discussed Israel's international relationships and efforts to broaden its diplomatic partnerships.

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Hans Raj Kumar S/o Late Shri Charan Pal Singh R/O E-30, Block-E, Gali No.1, East Vinod Nagar, Delhi-110091 have severed all relations with his son Lakshay and daughter-in-law Bharti and debarred them from all movable and immovable properties due to their misconduct, and shall not be responsible for any of their acts.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under instructions from and on behalf of my client Mr. Jayanand Jha, Resident of House No. 361 Gali No. 3, Vinay Nagar, Agrawal, Amar Nagar, Faridabad, Haryana-121003, I am hereby informed to the general public that he has severed all social, familial and financial relations with his son Harsh Jha and has disowned him from his movable and immovable properties with immediate effect.

Henceforth, neither my client nor his family members shall be responsible for any kind of transaction, debt, dispute or any anti-social/illegal activities conducted by Harsh Jha.

Sd/-
Counsel for the Client
Advocate Rashmi Kalyal
Chamber No. 228, G-Block,
Second Floor, Karkardoomi
Court, Shahdara, Delhi-11003

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Mr. Sonu Kumar is the GPA Holder of Property Bearing No. 124, area measuring 42 Sq. yds., out of Khata No. 60, situated at Village Karanval Nagar, in the abadi of New Sahaspur Gurgaon, Village Shahdara, Delhi. He is in Possession through GPA, ATS & Will dated 25.08.2028 executed by Mrs. Neelam in favour of Mr. Sonu Kumar in respect of the area measuring 42 Sq. Yds., out of Khata No. 60.

Mr. Sonu Kumar intends to transfer the ownership of above said property by way of Sale Deed to Mr. Nishu Gupta and Mrs. Sheelam Gupta. Subsequently, Mr. Nishu Gupta and Mrs. Sheelam Gupta are in the process of mortgaging the said property with SBI India Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7-day period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.

If anyone wishes to raise any objection, please do so within the stipulated 7-day period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 15, 1st Floor, Kirti Plaza, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline: 91012-04499711; e-mail: accounts@lwnorth.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given in the General Public that Mr. Shamshad Ahmad is the owner of A Residential Plot area measuring 60.67 sq. yds. (6067 sq. ft.) situated at Mahalla Amba Vihar City in Muzaffargarh Pargana & Tehsil & District Muzaffargarh (U.P.). Same is Owned by Sale Deed Dated 30.12.2009 Document No. 4442 executed by Mrs. Nazneen Shah W/o Mr. Saifuddin Mazhar in Favor of Mr. Shamshad Ahmad S/o Late Mr. Iqbal Ahmad, that The Page No. 03 (E-0001) Stamp Paper of this Sale Deed has been lost that Mr. Shamshad has informed to U.P. Police. All Persons are hereby informed that Mr. Shamshad Ahmad & Mrs. Shahana Parveen are mortgaging the said property with Amrit Malwa Capital Ltd. General public hereby informed that if anybody found this document or Any Person, Corporation, company, financial institution & others has any claim/charge/interest/title in the said property or any kind of dispute kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 07 days of the present.

Robit Kumar Advocate
Medhawi Enforcement & Legal Service
Office No. 314, Third Floor, Kishabh Cloud 9, Sector-41 Vaishali Ghazipur U.P. Mob no: 7396601626, 9818711626, Email: medhawienforcement@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given in the General Public that Mohd. Gulsher S/o Mohd. Hasan is the owner of A Residential Plot No. 31, Area measuring 60 sq. yard (60.14 sq. meter), out of Khata No. 01762, Situated at Village Dars Kotla S/o Swad Baran, Pargana & Tehsil & District Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh, Same is Owned by Sale Deed Dated 04.01.2021 Document No. 142 executed by Mr. Rahat Ali Khan S/o Mr. Barkat Ali Khan in Favor of Mohd. Gulsher S/o Mohd. Hasan, that The Page No. 03 (E-0001) Stamp Paper of this Sale Deed has been lost that Mr. Shoyab informed to U.P. Police with reference No. 00132260211539, All Persons are hereby informed that Mr. Mohd. Gulsher & Mr. Shoyab are mortgaging the said property with Amrit Malwa Capital Ltd. General public hereby informed that if anybody found this document or Any Person, Corporation, company, financial institution & others has any claim/charge/interest/title in the said property or any kind of dispute kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 07 days of the present.

Robit Kumar Advocate
Medhawi Enforcement & Legal Service
Office No. 314, Third Floor, Kishabh Cloud 9, Sector-41 Vaishali Ghazipur U.P. Mob no: 7396601626, 9818711626, Email: medhawienforcement@gmail.com

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Follow us on @SCRRailwayIndia
Details of the Tender Notices of S.C. Railway can be seen on our website : www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer, Secunderabad Division, South Central Railway, Secunderabad invites open tenders for the following works through e-Procurement of the Tenders.

Sl. No. 1, Tender No. & Date: C_SG_36_605 Dt:29/05/2026, Closing dt: 19/06/2026, **Name of the work:** 1. Signaling arrangements at proposed development of PQRS siding at Yelgur (YGL) station 2. KZJ-KI: Telecom arrangements in connection with provision PQRS siding at YGL 3. Signaling arrangements at KZJ-KI Section: Ancillary works for Ballast depot at PNPD station under ADEN.MDR sub-division. (PH 3100, IRPSM ID: 11.05.31.25.4.54.009) 4. Signaling arrangements for KZJ-KI Section: Proposed extension of ballast siding line at PNPD station under ADEN/MDR sub-division. 5. Telecom arrangements for KZJ-KI Section: Proposed extension of ballast siding line at PNPD station under ADEN/MDR sub-division, **Approx Value (₹):** 4,86,84,349.95, **Bid security/ EMD (₹):** 9,73,700.00

For further details visit the website www.ireps.gov.in; Bid security/ EMD to be paid as per GCC 2022

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer/ Secunderabad

Tender Notice No.09/2026 Dt.29.05.2026

Supply of Stores Items E-Procurement Tender Notice

The following tenders have been floated online. Tenders are requested to visit the website www.ireps.gov.in and submit their offers online. The Tender Description, Qty, EMD, SD may be seen in website. Offers submitted manually will not be accepted. Offers by post will not be entertained. Tender closing time is 14.30 hrs of the due date of the tender. "For all Indigenous offers, EMD will be accepted only via online system as available on www.ireps.gov.in."

Tender No.	Brief Description
66265488B	Track Machine Spares of plasser make
LH27455A	Supply, and installation of FRP Modular Toilet
76261271	Solid MIG/MAG Welding Filler wire-1.2mm Dia Class-IV
76261017	Manual Metal Arc Welding electrodes size 4.00x450mm
82264991	TKR Implants fixed Bearings-Oxonium Coated
38261145	Modified Elastomeric pad (Design-A)
38262186	Inner Spring For Casnub 22 HS Bogie
80261239	Transformer Oil for 3ph Locos
38262187	Outer Spring
31261021	Semi Permanent
38262390	Secondary brake beam
38262387	Draft Gear with follower
38261237	Shank wear plate for CBC
38262357	Round plate Bonded with stopper spring
6221197	Stainless steel pipe 20mm
67265007	Supply, installation, testing & commissioning of 500 T Wheel Press
67245007C	Supply, installation, testing & commissioning of 30/05 Tones EOT Crane

Note:- Due dates of Tender Opening

SL. No. 01 802 on dt.15.06.2026, SL. No. 03 & 04 on dt. 16.06.2026, SL. No. 05 dt. 17.06.2026, SL. No. 06 & 07 on dt. 19.06.2026, SL. No. 08 & 09 on dt. 22.06.2026, SL. No. 10 & 11 on dt. 23.06.2026, SL. No. 12 to 14 on dt. 29.06.2026, SL. No. 15 on dt. 01.07.2026, SL. No.16 on dt. 02.07.2026, SL.No.17 on dt.06.07.2026

CORRIGENDUM

Tender Notice No.07/2026 dt. 15.05.2026 Tender No.60266185 due on 08.06.2026 may be read as Due DT. 15.06.2026.

Beside above mentioned Tenders There are other Tenders having value above Rs. 50 Lakhs for details, please visit Railway website above.

Principal Chief Materials Manager/ A400 Secunderabad

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

BRIEFLY

Volpato to switch nationality ahead of World Cup



Italy Under-21 forward Cristian Volpato is changing national eligibility to Australia ahead of the World Cup, four years after he declined an invitation ahead of the 2022 tournament. Football Australia said Friday the Sydney-born Volpato has been added to the Socceroos' training camp in Los Angeles, before its squad is finalised by Monday. The 22-year-old Sassuolo player is eligible to make the switch under FIFA rules because he never played a competitive game for the senior Italy team. The Australian soccer body said it "received a release letter from the Italian Football Federation" – a key step for FIFA to approve switching national eligibility. Australia opens its World Cup campaign against Turkey on June 13 in Vancouver, plays the United States six days later in Seattle, and finishes Group D against Paraguay on June 25 at the San Francisco 49ers' stadium. The top two in the standings go to the round of 32 and the third-place team also can advance. Volpato turned down Australia ahead of the 2022 World Cup when he played his club soccer for Roma under coach Jose Mourinho. (AP)

US Open adds qualifying round for mixed doubles



The US Open is adding a qualifying round to its mixed doubles tournament, a boost for traditional doubles specialists who were largely shut out of last year's event in favour of singles stars. The US Tennis Association said on Thursday that there would be an eight-team qualifying competition on August 24, where the teams will be playing for the last two spots in the 16-team main draw. Sara Errani and Andrea Vavassori won their second straight title in New York last year, but they were the only true doubles team in the event and even as defending champions needed a wild card just to get back. Eight teams got in by the players' combined singles rankings, with the remaining teams given wild cards. The USTA revamped the event last year and moved it to the beginning of the tournament. Doubles players criticized the format as more of an exhibition for excluding them, especially with a \$1 million prize to the winners that was far more than usually could earn. The first round and quarterfinals of the mixed doubles will be played August 25, with the semifinals and final on August 26. (AP)

Rodrigues, Yastika and Nandani power India to win over England

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Chelmsford (UK)

Jemimah Rodrigues and Yastika Bhatia struck fluent half-centuries before debutant pacer Nandani Sharma starred with the ball as an experimental India defeated England by 38 runs to take a 1-0 lead in the three-match women's T20I series. Playing without regular captain Harmanpreet Kaur, India recovered from a disastrous start to post 188 for seven and then restricted England to 150 for eight at the County Ground on Thursday. This is India's final series before next month's T20 World Cup that begins on June 12. Stand-in skipper Smriti Mandhana got out for a golden duck, while her opening partner Shafali Verma capped a forgettable three-ball two with Lauren Bell (3/34) giving a fiery start to England after they opted to bowl. But Rodrigues made 69 off 40 balls (1x6, 10x4s) and Yastika marked her return to the format after two years with a brisk 54 off 40 deliveries, her maiden T20I.

Yastika and Rodrigues counter-attacked brilliantly, stitching together a 126-run stand for the third wicket off just 76 balls to turn the innings around.

Yastika, returning after knee surgery and playing her first T20I since April 2024, raced to her fifty in 31 balls with nine fours and a six.

Rodrigues was equally aggressive, striking 10 boundaries and a six while bringing up her half-century off 31 deliveries.

England's sloppy fielding compounded their problems before Charlie Dean provided some relief by effecting Yastika's run out and then dismissing Rodrigues in the same over.

India briefly lost momentum as Richa Ghosh and Bharti Fulmali fell cheaply, but Deepti Sharma's unbeaten 22 off 13 balls and Arundhati Reddy's late cameo ensured a strong finish.



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Built myself from scratch after injury, says Yastika



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Chelmsford (UK)

India batter Yastika Bhatia said she had to build herself from scratch after a career-threatening ACL injury, enduring months of painful rehabilitation before returning with a match-winning half-century against England in the first women's T20I. Yastika, who injured her left knee during India's preparatory camp for last year's ODI World Cup in Visakhapatnam, marked her comeback with a fluent 54 off 40 balls in India's 38-run win in the opening women's T20I ahead of World Cup beginning on June 12. "I think those who undergo ACL surgery know how difficult it is because a whole muscle of that leg goes away. You literally have to build everything from scratch," Yastika said after the match. The left-hander admitted there were phases during rehabilitation when progress seemed invisible. "After the surgery, the rehab process was pretty tough. There were days when nothing was happening and no progress was visibly seen. But I just kept showing up every day," she said. "After months, I could finally see improvement. The support system around me was beautiful... the Centre of Excellence staff, family, friends, teammates like Jemmy (Jemimah Rodrigues), everyone kept checking on me. I'm very grateful... all's well that ends well." The injury had forced Yastika to miss India's triumphant ODI World Cup campaign at home last year.

Gukesh sinks to bottom after losing to Carlsen; Pragg stays second

AJAI MASAND ■ Oslo

World number 1 Magnus Carlsen returned to winning ways with a crushing victory over reigning classical world champion D Gukesh, sending the young Indian to the bottom of the standings, while R Praggnanandhaa stayed second after beating Vincent Keymer in Armageddon at the Norway Chess in Oslo. Seven-time Norway Chess champion Carlsen, who had endured a sluggish start to the tournament, climbed from last to sole fourth with 4.5 points after bagging three full points, while a dejected Gukesh slipped away quietly from the playing hall through a side exit, leaving scores of young fans waiting for autographs. Going into Friday's rest day, Alireza Firouzja remained comfortably on top despite suffering his first defeat of the event – an Armageddon loss to Wesley So after their classical game ended in a draw. Firouzja still collected a valuable point to move to 8.5, maintaining a healthy 2.5-point lead over sole second-placed Praggnanandhaa on six points. American Wesley So sits third on 5.5 points, a point ahead of Carlsen, while Keymer is on four. At the bottom is reigning world champion Gukesh on 3.5 points, as the tournament threatens to turn into another nightmare campaign for the young Indian ahead of his world title defence against challenger Javokhir Sindarov later this year. There were no table-slams or dramatic "Oh my God!" moments from Carlsen this time, unlike his emotional loss to Gukesh last year, as the Norwegian great clinically converted his advantage with the black pieces. (PTI)



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US trains for World Cup at new \$250 million, 200-acre, 19-field complex

RONALD BLUM
■ Fayetteville (US)

Jozy Altidore arrived at the new US Soccer National Training Centre, a \$250 million, 200-acre, 19-field complex south of Atlanta, far different from where his 2014 American team recovered from practice in a plastic cold tub on a paved path outside Stanford's Cagan Stadium in California. "This is the culmination, right?" the retired striker said on Thursday. "This is what I'm sure past players strived to want to be a part of." As the Americans prepare to host the World Cup next month, the national team programs have progressed light years. Sunil Gulati, who would later become US Soccer Federation president, recalled buying balls from a Kmart on the morning of an intrasquad game at Colorado Springs, Colorado, filled with players trying to earn spots for the US roster going to the 1985 FIFA Under-16 World Championship. And then sprinklers went off during the match. Facilities kept improving ever so slightly. The Americans based ahead of the 1994 World Cup at a \$3.5 million, seven-acre facility opened the previous year in Mission Viejo, California. They switched to a training center in Chula Vista, California, for 1998, then trained in Cary, North Carolina, in 2002 and 2006. The team moved to Princeton in 2010 and Stanford in 2014. In recent years, national team practices took place at Major League Soccer training facilities. The new training center, opened May 7, was funded with a \$50 million lead gift from Atlanta Falcons and MLS team owner Arthur Bank. It was built on a former cow pasture about 25 miles from Atlanta and is home to all 27 US national teams. (AP)



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Lionel Messi is in Argentina's World Cup squad as coach Scaloni calms injury fears

DEBORA REY ■ Buenos Aires

Amid a worrying rash of injuries, Argentina coach Lionel Scaloni sought to dispel doubts by confirming that most of the reigning world champions, including captain Lionel Messi, will be part of the squad that will seek a second consecutive title at the 2026 World Cup. Messi, about to turn 39, headlines the 26-man World Cup roster announced by the Argentine Football Association on Thursday. Of those called up, 17 players were part of the team that triumphed four years ago in the final against France in Qatar. Several of those players were in doubt due to injuries of varying severity, close to the June 1 deadline set by FIFA for finalising World Cup squads. Among them was Messi himself, who is suffering from muscle fatigue and strain in his left hamstring, which prevented him from finishing the match with Inter Miami last Sunday. The club has officially stated that his recovery time will depend on "his clinical and functional progress." Messi will be playing in his sixth World Cup, having previously participated in Germany 2006, South Africa 2010, Brazil 2015, Russia 2018 and Qatar 2022. Goalkeeper Martinez named: Goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez, who fractured the ring finger of his right hand during last week's Europa League final in which Aston Villa defeated Freiburg, has also been confirmed. Scaloni also included defender Cristian Romero, who is recovering from a sprained collateral ligament in his right knee suffered in mid-April while playing for Tottenham, and full-backs Nahuel Molina and Gonzalo Montiel, who scored the decisive penalty kicks in the 2002 World Cup shootout against France, both of whom are recovering from muscle injuries. Argentina, also world champions in 1978 and 1986, will debut on June 16 against Algeria in Group J, which also includes Austria and Jordan. The squad will travel on Saturday to their World Cup base in Kansas City and will play friendlies against Honduras and Iceland before the start of the tournament. ARGENTINA SQUAD: Goalkeepers: Emiliano Martinez (Aston Villa), Geronimo Rulli (Olympique de Marseille), Juan Musso (Atletico de Madrid). Defenders: Gonzalo Montiel (River Plate), Nahuel Molina (Atletico de Madrid), Lisandro Martinez (Manchester United), Nicolas Otamendi (Benfica), Leonardo Balerdi (Olympique de Marseille), Cristian Romero (Tottenham), Nicolas Tagliafico (Olympique de Lyon), Facundo Medina (Olympique de Marseille). Midfielders: Giovanni Lo Celso (Beti), Leandro Paredes (Boca Jrs), Rodrigo De Paul (Inter Miami), Exequiel Palacios (Bayer Leverkusen), Enzo Fernandez (Chelsea), Alexis Mac Allister (Liverpool), Valentin Barco (RC Strasbourg Alsace). Forwards: Lionel Messi (Inter Miami), Nicolas Gonzalez (Atletico de Madrid), Giuliano Simeone (Atletico de Madrid), Lautaro Martinez (Inter Milan), Jose Manuel Lopez (Palmeiras), Julian Alvarez (Atletico de Madrid), Thiago Almada (Lyon), Nico Paz (Como). (AP)

FIFA for finalising World Cup squads.

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Chinnappa, 3 other Indians in top 10 at AM Green IGPL Morocco Rising Stars

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ El Jadida (Morocco)

Indian golfer Trishul Chinnappa staged a great recovery on his second nine with five birdies in last six holes, to move into the top 10 after the first round of the \$160,000 AM Green IGPL Morocco Rising Stars 2026. He was tied eighth with three other Indians, Sudhir Sharma, Raghav Chugh and Syed Saqib Ahmed. They were three shots behind the leader Hoho Yue of Hong Kong, who shot 6-under 66. Like Chinnappa, Saqib also had a fine second nine with three birdies, while Sharma, who started the round in the very last group of the day, had an eagle on his first nine. Chugh, who teed off in the second group in the morning, had five birdies against two bogeys.



The event, being played at the stunning Mazagan Beach & Golf Resort, is co-sanctioned with the AM Green Indian Golf Premier League (IGPL).

The four Indians, all prominent players on the AM Green IGPL Tour, are still searching for their maiden success on the AM Green IGPL and the ADT Tours.

No decision on future until after World Cup: Pochettino

RONALD BLUM ■ Fayetteville (US)

US coach Mauricio Pochettino said his agent may have spoken with AC Milan and he also may have had a casual conversation with the Italian club but he remains open to staying with the American national team after the World Cup. Speaking after training on Thursday, Pochettino said he and US Soccer Federation CEO JT Batson discussed the possibility of staying on during dinner Sunday at Jean-Georges, a highly rated and pricey restaurant in New York. "He asked if we are open to listen (to) the project of the federation for the next four years," Pochettino said. "And we said: Of course that we are open. Do you think that if we have a commitment with another people, we are going to waste time to listen?" Pochettino agreed in September 2024 to a contract through the World Cup. He said until Sunday "we didn't have (any) idea about if the federation was happy with us or not happy, wanted us for the future." Pochettino said it was good that his name was linked to big clubs, it means "we are doing something good."



He said until Sunday "we didn't have (any) idea about if the federation was happy with us or not happy, wanted us for the future." Pochettino said it was good that his name was linked to big clubs, it means "we are doing something good."

"The problem is ... the opposite, no one asks for you," he said. Pochettino maintained not much significance should be made of AC Milan's discussions. "My representatives, maybe, possible, because they need to do their job," he said. "Do you think all the people that represent different coaches have no conversation with different clubs?" Pochettino avoided revealing whether he was personally involved in a meeting. "If I met someone, what happened? What is going to change if I met someone?" he said. "We have friends everywhere and my representative works for me into trying to find the best possibility for the future. That is normal." Discussion of Pochettino's future isn't impacting players. "I think I'm someone that lives in present day and right now he's here and we're working with him," winger Tim Weah said. "It's an amazing feeling having

"DO YOU THINK ALL THE PEOPLE THAT REPRESENT DIFFERENT COACHES HAVE NO CONVERSATION WITH DIFFERENT CLUBS?" —Pochettino such a prestigious coach coaching us." "He had standing offers from other places to come and he wanted to be here," Batson said. "There has been a longer list of outreach than what has even been reported." Pochettino, 54, was hired after coaching at Espanyol, Tottenham, Paris Saint-Germain and Chelsea. Batson wouldn't say whether the USSF has reached out to Pep Guardiola or Jurgen Klopp, two high-profile coaching free agents. (AP)

Gill's century powers Gujarat Titans into IPL final

BHARAT SHARMA ■ Mullanpur

Shubman Gill produced a conventional batting masterclass in the age of muscle on the way to a majestic hundred here on Friday, leading Gujarat Titans to a dominating seven-wicket win over Rajasthan Royals and a third final in five seasons of the Indian Premier League.

First it was boy wonder Vaibhav Sooryavanshi who played some astonishing shots in a brilliantly paced 96 off 47 balls to steer Rajasthan Royals to 214 for six after Royals opted to bat on a used surface in the Qualifier

2. The target was in the range of a top-heavy Titans but they ended up making short work of it courtesy a special 167-run stand off 77 balls between the prolific opening duo of Gill (104 off 53) and Sai Sudharsan (58 off 32).

Freakishly, Sudharsan lost the control of his bat for the second game in a row to be hit wicket. Titans coasted to the target in 18.4 overs.

Titans will meet defending champions Royal Challengers Bengaluru in the final in Ahmedabad on Sunday, days after being hammered by the same

team in Dharamsala.

Highlighting their remarkable consistency, Titans have entered the final thrice since their inaugural season in 2022 when they lifted the trophy.

Rajasthan Royals have two X-factor players in Sooryavanshi and Jofra Archer and both had to deliver to take their team to the final. Sooryavanshi did but on a rare occasion Archer went wicket-less in the powerplay and the others failed to step up.

The manner in which Gill and Sudharsan batted in the chase was a treat for the purists of the game. Piercing



the field with proper cricketing shots is their strength and that is what they did to perfection.

Gill loves the pull shot and he executed it with ease even against the express pace of Jofra Archer. He used the feet against spinners for boundaries and used the same tactic to reach his hundred, picking Jadeja for a four over extra cover.

With the kind of season Gill has had, he has made a strong case for his inclusion in the India T20 squad after being dropped in the lead-up to the World Cup. He collected 15 fours and three sixes in his classy knock.

There was a bigger crowd in attendance than on Wednesday night, and the majority of them turned up to watch 15-year-old Sooryavanshi go about his belligerent business.

They got more than their money's worth with Sooryavanshi continuing to boss the best bowlers around, including Kagiso Rabada and Jason Holder on this occasion.

Having lost Yashavi Jaiswal and Dhruv Jurel inside the second over, Sooryavanshi needed to adapt on a used surface where Mohammed Siraj, Rabada and Prasadh Krishna

came with a clear plan: bowl back of a length into the body and throw in the odd bouncer to contain Sooryavanshi.

With the same pitch picked for the second game in a row, the ball did not come on to the bat as nicely as it did in the Eliminator.

Sooryavanshi was not able to time the ball early on with the bowlers not giving him anything to free his arms. Despite the challenges thrown at him, Sooryavanshi was still able to play awe-inducing shots with the best one being a straight six off a 153 kmph back of length delivery from Rabada. (PTI)

Rishabh Pant steps down from LSG captaincy



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Dashing keeper-batter Rishabh Pant has been relieved from Lucknow Super Giants' captaincy after a disastrous 2026 IPL season where they finished last among 10 teams.

As a batter, it turned out to be a woeful season where he got only 312 runs in 14 innings. On May 14, the PTI had reported that Pant was set to lose captaincy, something which was reiterated by LSG's Director of Cricket Tom Moody. "Lucknow Super Giants (LSG) wish to formally announce that Rishabh Pant has request-

ed to be relieved of his captaincy duties with the franchise, and the franchisee has accepted his request with immediate effect," the franchise said in an official statement.

"Rishabh approached the franchisee with this request and we have respectfully accepted it," Moody was quoted as saying in the media release.

"These decisions are never easy. We are grateful for everything Rishabh has brought to this dressing room as captain. Our focus now is on the collective rebuilding and restructuring to reach the best standards," the former Australian all-rounder added.

Spin legend Anil Kumble lauds Sooryavanshi's consistency



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Mullanpur

In awe of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's power-hitting, Indian spin legend Anil Kumble said he is also very impressed with the consistency that the fearless youngster has exhibited in the ongoing IPL.

Sooryavanshi made history by smashing 65 sixes in a single IPL season. This extraordinary feat shattered the previous all-time IPL record of 59 sixes, which was held by West Indian marauder Chris Gayle since 2012.

The 15-year-old is the highest run-scorer and Orange Cap holder of the

ongoing IPL, amassing 680 runs in just 15 innings for Rajasthan Royals. He also recently broke the world record for scoring the most runs in a single T20 series by a teenager.

"Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is the Orange Cap holder, and that doesn't come from doing it just once or against a couple of teams. He's done it consistently over the last two months, and that says a lot about the youngster.

"It's not just about going out there and bashing a few sixes, even though he is the highest six-hitter now," Kumble told JioHotstar's 'Game Plan'.

Back from ligament injury, Pranati Nayak targets higher D-score ahead of Asian meet

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kolkata

Back after a successful return, experienced top Indian gymnast Pranati Nayak says she will now focus on increasing her difficulty level ahead of the Asian Championships after making a successful return from injury with a silver medal at the FIG World Challenge Cup in Tashkent.

The 31-year-old Tokyo

Olympian, who is also a three-time Asian Championships bronze medallist in vault, returned to international competition after a gap of nearly seven months winning a silver at the FIG World Challenge Cup in Uzbekistan.

With a packed calendar ahead of her in Asian Championships, Commonwealth Games and the Asian Games, Pranati,



"WITH ASIAN CHAMPIONSHIP S JUST 3 WEEKS AWAY, FOCUS IS NOW ON IMPROVING EXECUTION AND LANDING."
—Pranati Nayak

I worked hard on fitness when I was not in IPL: Sarfaraz Khan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Mumbai

India and Chennai Super Kings batter Sarfaraz Khan on Friday said he worked on his fitness and strike rate in white ball cricket during the two years he missed playing in the Indian Premier League.

The right-handed Mumbai batter was not picked by any side in the IPL editions of 2024 and 2025, before he made a comeback with Chennai Super Kings this year.

"The biggest challenge for me in IPL was to make a comeback and to play with a good strike rate," Sarfaraz told reporters during jersey launch of Mumbai Western Suburbs Aakash Tigers here ahead of the fourth edition of the T20 Mumbai League.

"There was some issue with the strike rate in between, and also due to fitness, I was not there in the IPL for two years. The biggest challenge for me was making a comeback," he said. "I needed to improve

my strike rate and fitness. That's one reason I was out of the IPL for two years. I worked hard on fitness, fielding, and batting, and I got good results. I'll continue to improve," he added.

Talking about his performance this year, he said, "You can never be fully satisfied in cricket. You have to wake up each day, work hard and learn something new everyday. "I spent 2 months there (at CSK) and learnt a lot. Everyone knows that Dhoni's (room) doors are never closed, so whenever needed, we used to discuss cricket."



Bhuvneshwar combines virtues, variations

G UNNIKRISHNAN ■ Ahmedabad

Shubman Gill pressed forward to swat Bhuvneshwar Kumar across the line, but the ball came wee bit in from good length to rattle the stumps of Gujarat Titans' captain. It was as unremarkable a dismissal as one would see across this season of the IPL.

But that 10-second moment in the Qualifier 1 at Dharamsala carried the essence of Bhuvneshwar's bowling - old-school, minimal but highly effective.

The 36-year-old pacer is now a frontrunner for this year's Purple Cap, having taken 26 wickets at an impressive economy rate of 8, and only Jason Holder (7.63) has been thrifter among the top 20 bowlers than Bhuvneshwar.

In that, 12 wickets have come inside the Power Play segment at an astounding economy of around 7, fuelling Royal Challengers Bengaluru's



march to a second successive IPL final.

It has been a remarkable transition by Bhuvneshwar - once deemed unsuitable for T20 format because of his lack of pace to the second highest wicket-taker in the league with 222 wickets.

So, how does he manage to keep himself relevant in the age of range-hitting and flat tracks? After all, some of the more revered names have withered in this unforgiving league.

Omkar Salvi, the RCB bowling

coach, offered some insight.

"Everyone knows what a world-class bowler he is and the skills he possesses. Every bowler has their own strengths and teams plan according to that. Bhuv is bowling with the new ball, so naturally he wants to explore the swing.

"At the death as well, he has been using his variations effectively. It depends on which phase he is operating in," said Salvi. (PTI)

Odisha gymnastics' curious case: ₹1.96cr invoice in dead president's name

TAPAN MOHANTA ■ Bhubaneswar

In a country where sports administration is often under the scanner for varied reasons, the Odisha Gymnastics Association may have produced one of its more curious cases with the body continuing to use the name of a president who died over a year ago for communication seeking funds from the State Government.

A complaint submitted to the commissioner-cum-secretary of Odisha's Sports & Youth Services Department has questioned how the OGA managed to secure nearly



₹98 lakh from the State Government for the 2026 National Gymnastics Championships even as invoices of more than ₹1.96-crore and official documents continued to carry the name of late

Samir Dey as president.

The event was held from April 25 to may 3 at Kalinga Stadium. Dey, a former minister in the previous Patnaik-led BJD Government, died in November 2024.

"It is quite intriguing to note that the Association is running with a president who has passed one and half years ago," complainant Balunkeswar Sahoo wrote in his letter which was received by the sports department on May 27 and a copy of which is in possession of PTI.

The issue becomes even more striking because the invoice of more than ₹1.96 crore raised for the National Championships had Dey's name as president with the signature of OGA general secretary Ashok Sahoo dated April 23, 2026.

Responding to the "ghost president" allegation, Sahoo said the association had continued using old stationery despite a change

of guard.

"Dhiren Panda is currently functioning as the in-charge of the association. We have not printed fresh letterheads yet," OGA general secretary Sahoo said.

"The present committee will be dissolved by August and fresh elections will be conducted in compliance with the National Sports Code," said Sahoo, who has already completed three consecutive terms and would be ineligible to contest again.

When contacted, the offices of the commissioner-cum-secretary of Odisha Sports and Youth Services Department declined to "comment" on the matter. (PTI)



Sindhu falls to nemesis An Se Young; Satwik-Chirag in semis

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Singapore

India's PV Sindhu lacked the consistency required to trouble world number 1 An Se Young for sustained periods, going down in the quarterfinals but ace men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty moved into the semifinals with a hard-fought win at the Singapore Open Super 750 badminton tournament here on Friday.

The two-time Olympic medallist showed flashes of her attacking best and managed to put the Korean under pressure in phases, but An's superior control, movement and ability to win the crucial points ensured another comfortable 21-17 21-14 victory in their lopsided rivalry.

The loss extended Sindhu's winless run against the reigning Olympic champion to nine matches. Across those meetings, the Indian has

managed to take a game off An only once, at the 2023 Badminton Asia Championships.

Satwik and Chirag, the Asian Games champion and fourth seeds here, came from a game down to get the better of Malaysia's Khai Xing Kang and Aaron Tai 19-21 21-17 21-13 in a gruelling contest that lasted one hour and five minutes.

The Indian pair will now be up against top seeds Kim

Won Ho and Seo Seung Jae of Korea, who defeated seventh seeded Japanese combination of Takuro Hoki and Yugo Kobayashi 21-19 21-18.

Sindhu vs An Se Young: The challenge was always formidable for Sindhu against an opponent who has lost just one match this year after suffering only four defeats in the whole of 2025, underlining the Korean's remarkable dominance on the world circuit.

BCCI bans smart sunglasses in IPL

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

The BCCI's Anti-Corruption Unit has barred the usage of smart sunglasses by players and match officials in the ongoing IPL, citing its advanced communication features which allow live streaming and video calling through mobile data or Wi-Fi networks.

In an advisory to the league's franchisees, the BCCI ACSU has stated that it has been noticed that some companies are marketing and selling smart sunglasses to players and support staff.

"Kindly note that these devices are equipped with advanced communication



features, including live streaming, sending and receiving text messages, as well as audio and video calling capabilities through mobile data or Wi-Fi networks," the Board said.